

Toh 66 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-mahā-pra

Toh 66 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 66 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-mahā-pratihārya-nirdeśa-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra and in Tibetan as "The Noble Demonstration of the Great Miracle"

(འཕགས་པ་རྒྱལ་བ་ཡོན་ཏན་རིན་པོ་འཕེལ་བཤད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་རྟེན་གྱི་ཆུང་མཛུབ་ཀྱི་ཁྲིམས་ཀྱི་ཞུས་པ་ལྟར།). It forms a chapter — specifically the twenty-second chapter, concerning the demonstration of a great miraculous display — within the vast scriptural collection known as the Great Jewel Heap (*Mahāratnakūṭa*), a compendium spanning one hundred thousand chapters and gathering together numerous Dharma categories. The text is set in the familiar canonical scene of the Buddha residing in the Jeta Grove at Śrāvastī, surrounded by a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. It was translated into Tibetan by the abbot Jinamitra, Prajñāvarman, and the editor-translator monk Yeshé Dé, and belongs to the Ratnakūṭa section of the Kangyur.

Translated by the abbot Jinamitra, Prajñāvarman, and the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and others; they translated, reviewed, and established the final text.

From the noble Great Jewel Heap, that vast compendium of Dharma categories, in one hundred thousand chapters: the twenty-second chapter, "Demonstrating the Great Miracle." First fascicle.

In the language of India:
Ārya-mahā-pratihārya-nirdeśa-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: The Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Noble Demonstration of the Great Miracle."

I bow to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove — the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada — together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks, and with eight thousand bodhisattvas.

Then a divine youth (deva-son) by the name of Caravan Leader assembled in that very gathering and sat down. Mañjuśrī in the form of a youth also assembled in that very gathering and sat down.

Then the divine youth Caravan Leader addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what kind of miracle does the Tathāgata tame sentient beings?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine youth, I tame sentient beings by means of three kinds of miracle. What are these three? They are: the miracle of universal proclamation, the miracle of sequential instruction, and the miracle of supernatural powers.

"Now, what is the Tathāgata's miracle of universal proclamation? It is the unobstructed gnosis (jñāna) by which the Tathāgata perceives the future; the knowing and seeing of the mental conduct of every sentient being; causing those who have no faith in the Three Jewels to gain faith; knowing the workings of karmic maturation; and proclaiming, exactly as it is and not otherwise, that such-and-such a person, on account of the wrongful conduct he is engaged in right now, will be reborn in bad states of existence — in one or another of the lower realms.

"Furthermore, that person, on account of having genuinely taken up wholesome roots, will be freed from the lower realms and will be reborn among gods or humans; and by which vehicle he will attain definitive liberation — whether by the vehicle of the śrāvakas, or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, or by the Great Vehicle — and likewise what pleasure and suffering he will experience, and after how many aeons he will attain definitive liberation, and by what kind of conduct he will come to see however many blessed buddhas there are and will come to please them: all of this is perfectly known by the Tathāgata. And knowing it, the Tathāgata proclaims it exactly as it is and not otherwise. This constitutes making a proclamation according to reality.

"Furthermore, whatever person, on account of having genuinely taken up wholesome roots, will be reborn in the desire realms, or in whichever birth-place of the form realm or the formless realm — this too is perfectly known by the Tathāgata. By what vehicle he will attain definitive liberation, after how many aeons he will attain definitive liberation, and by what kind of conduct he will come to see however many blessed buddhas there are and will come to please them — all of this too is perfectly known by the Tathāgata. And knowing it, the Tathāgata proclaims it and makes prophetic declarations exactly as it is. Whether wholesome or non-wholesome, inferior or —"

— middling, or supreme — not even a single arising of mind passes unnoticed. That is the miracle of proclamation of the Tathāgata.

What, then, is the miracle of the Tathāgata's instruction? It is that he teaches by instruction for the sake of guarding the training, saying: "This is to be done. This is not to be done. This is to be relied upon. This is not to be relied upon. This is right practice. This is wrong practice. These phenomena are in accord with the side of affliction. These phenomena are in accord with the side of purification." In this way he teaches the taking up of every virtue in full, teaches the abandoning of every non-virtue, and teaches the taking up of every accumulation of virtuous paths — saying: "This path will bring the vehicle of the hearers to complete fulfilment. This path will bring the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas to complete fulfilment. This path will bring the Great Vehicle to complete fulfilment." If one practises exactly as taught, there is no place, no occasion where one would fail to attain the destination indicated — it is without that possibility. This action, if fully taken up, leads beings to the hells. This action, if fully taken up, leads to the birth-places of animals. This action, if fully taken up, leads to the worlds of Yama, the Lord of Death. This action, if fully taken up, leads to the gods. This action, if fully taken up, leads to the humans. And those who, abandoning non-virtue, enter upon the path of taking up virtue in full and enter the noble path — they, being born among gods and humans in succession, come to be of a nature that will pass fully beyond sorrow. In such a manner the Tathāgata teaches, without concealment and without confusion. That is the miracle of the Tathāgata's instruction.

What, then, is the miracle of the Tathāgata's supernormal power? For sentient beings who are to be tamed by supernormal power — those overcome by pride, arrogance, and conceit — he manifests the miracle of supernormal power in full. It is like this: from one he becomes many; from many he becomes one. He appears and then disappears. He passes straight through walls, through ramparts, through mountains, without obstruction. He rises up through the earth and plunges into it as a bird dives into water. He walks upon water without sinking, as though walking on solid ground. He travels through the sky just as a winged bird does. With his upper body he sends forth blazing fire while streams of water pour down from his lower body. With his lower body he sends forth blazing fire while streams of water pour down from his upper body. These two — the sun and the moon — great as they are in supernormal power, mighty as they are in strength, brilliant as they are in splendour — he seizes them with his hands and strokes them. He exercises dominion with his

body all the way up to the world of Brahmā. He causes this entire great trichiliocosm — this world-system of three thousand great thousands of worlds — to blaze throughout. For the purpose of bringing sentient beings to full maturation, he manifests those precise and varied modes of miraculous display by which sentient beings of each kind will be tamed. That is the miracle of the Tathāgata's supernormal power.

Son of the gods, it is through these three miracles that the Tathāgata tames sentient beings.

Then the son of the gods, the caravan leader, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, beyond those miracles, is there yet another supreme miracle that you possess?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of the gods, there is."

Then the Blessed One addressed Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, rouse yourself to teach this Dharma category called 'The Exposition of Miracles' — for whoever hears it, the great bodhisattvas (bodhisattvas) who engage with the profound will attain patience, the camp of Māra will be utterly routed, and the awakening of the Tathāgatas will long endure."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, addressed him in turn: "Blessed One, should the Tathāgata wish, he could take up in a single palm the entire mass of water filling the great oceans of this world-system of three thousand great thousands of worlds, and pour it out — yet it would cause no harm to the water-dwelling sentient beings whatsoever. Blessed One, this is a miracle the Tathāgata possesses. And yet this, too, is a supreme miracle: that having fully awakened to phenomena that are inexpressible, without syllable, without declaration, without arising, without production, without name, without sign, without sound, without tone, without the path of words, without reason, without defining characteristic, without activity, without movement, without origination, without cognition — unconditioned, free from mind, mentation, and consciousness, with all conventional designations utterly severed — phenomena that are peaceful, pure, subtle, difficult to see, not susceptible to analysis, and beyond the domain of logical reasoning — the Tathāgata, having fully awakened to such phenomena, then makes them known to others through letters, definitive words, symbols, and the various paths of conventional designation. That is the great miracle of the Tathāgata. That the world together with its gods cannot fathom the depth of this, and that all the ascetics and brahmins who operate

with reference-points, signs, and conceptual elaboration are unable to enter or penetrate it — that too is the great miracle of the Tathāgata.

"Blessed One, furthermore, should the Tathāgata wish, he could place this entire world-system of three thousand great thousands of worlds into his mouth — yet the sentient beings of the four great continents, the sun and moon, the parasols, the encircling ranges, the parks, the trees, the medicinal plants, and the forests would suffer no obstruction whatsoever. And drawing them back out and arranging them exactly as they had been, the sentient beings would not even notice: 'We were placed somewhere,' or 'We were taken out from somewhere.' Blessed One, that too is the great miracle of the Tathāgata.

"This is indeed the supremely great miracle: that having fully awakened to phenomena that are inexpressible, without syllable, without declaration, without name, without sign — and so on in the same manner — free from mind, mentation, and consciousness, with all conventional designations utterly severed, phenomena that are peaceful, pure, subtle, difficult to see, not susceptible to analysis —"

— that having fully awakened to all phenomena that lie beyond the domain of discursive thought, and then teaching those very phenomena through whatever means of letters, definitive words, signs, and conventional linguistic pathways — that too is the great miracle of the Tathāgata.

Blessed One, furthermore, all those miracles belonging to the body of the Tathāgata serve to draw in entirely all sentient beings who are endowed with objects and signs. This too is the great miracle of the Tathāgata: namely, applying the conventional designation "self" to what has no self, applying the conventional designation "sentient being" to what has no sentient being, applying the conventional designation "life" to what has no life, applying the conventional designation "nourishment" to what has no nourishment, applying the conventional designation "person" to what has no person, applying the conventional designation "born of seed" to what has no one born of seed, applying the conventional designation "offspring of seed" to what has no offspring of seed, applying the conventional designation "name" to what has no name, applying the conventional designation "form" to what has no form, applying the conventional designation "feeling" to what has no feeling, applying the conventional designation "perception" to what has no perception, applying the conventional designation "formations" to what has no formations,

applying the conventional designation "consciousness" to what has no consciousness, applying the conventional designation "aggregates" to what has no aggregates, applying the conventional designation "elements" to what has no elements, applying the conventional designation "sense sources" to what has no sense sources — and yet, though the conventional designation "the eye is empty" is applied, the eye does not think: "I am empty of self." And though the conventional designation "form is empty" is applied, form does not think: "I am empty of self." And though the conventional designation "eye-consciousness is empty" is applied, eye-consciousness does not think: "I am empty of self." And likewise with the ear, sound, and ear-consciousness; the nose, smell, and nose-consciousness; the tongue, taste, and tongue-consciousness; the body, tangible objects, and body-consciousness — and though the conventional designation "the mind is empty" is applied, the mind does not think: "I am empty of self." And though the conventional designation "phenomena are empty" is applied, phenomena do not think: "We are empty of self." And though the conventional designation "mind-consciousness is empty" is applied, mind-consciousness does not think: "I am empty of self."

In this way, that the Tathāgata causes other sentient beings and other persons to genuinely understand phenomena of this kind — phenomena that are inert, without thought, without thing, without name, without sign — this is the great miracle of the Tathāgata. And that miracle is not possessed of eye, not possessed of form, not possessed of eye-consciousness, not possessed of ear, not possessed of sound, not possessed of ear-consciousness, not possessed of nose, not possessed of smell, not possessed of nose-consciousness, not possessed of tongue, not possessed of taste, not possessed of tongue-consciousness, not possessed of body, not possessed of tangible objects, not possessed of body-consciousness, not possessed of mind, not possessed of phenomena, not possessed of mind-consciousness. Such a miracle as this is a miracle without object. It is a miracle devoid of object. And that miracle is not to be viewed as possessed of a body, or of mind —

or of mind, or of consciousness. It is for this reason that this miracle is something the entire world cannot fathom. Why is that? What is called "the world" is the five aggregates, and childish beings are deeply attached to those five aggregates, clinging to them as permanent. It is for this reason that this miracle is something the entire world cannot fathom.

The world expects the five aggregates to be permanent, and when one declares that they are impermanent, the entire world cannot fathom it. The world expects the five aggregates to be pleasurable, and when one declares that they are suffering, the entire world cannot fathom it. The world expects the five aggregates to be a self, and when one declares that they are without self, the entire world cannot fathom it. The world expects the five aggregates to be beautiful, and when one declares that they are not beautiful, the entire world cannot fathom it. The world expects the five aggregates to be mine, and when one declares that they have no owner, the entire world cannot fathom it. The world expects the five aggregates to be real, and when one declares that they are not real, the entire world cannot fathom it. It is for these reasons that this Tathāgata's miracle is something the entire world cannot fathom.

Toward that miracle, no mind can be made glad. That miracle is inconceivable. That miracle is not to be counted as eye, nor counted as form; that miracle has passed utterly beyond the domain of eye and form. That miracle is not to be counted as ear, nor counted as sound; that miracle has passed utterly beyond the domain of ear and sound. And so likewise it is to be understood throughout: that miracle is not to be counted as mind, nor counted as phenomena; that miracle has passed utterly beyond the domain of mind and phenomena. That miracle is not the domain of consciousness. It does not bring satisfaction. That miracle is not something to be cognized.

Emptiness is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of emptiness is itself a miracle. The signless (Skt. *animitta*) is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of the signless is itself a miracle. The wishless (Skt. *apraṇihita*) is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of the wishless is itself a miracle. Non-construction is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of non-construction is itself a miracle. Non-arising is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of non-arising is itself a miracle. Non-occurrence is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of non-occurrence is itself a miracle. The absence of things is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of the absence of things is itself a miracle. The absence of defining characteristics is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of the absence of defining characteristics is itself a miracle. Non-cessation is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of non-cessation is itself a miracle. Nirvāṇa is inexpressible, and yet the very speaking of nirvāṇa is itself a miracle. And so it is —

Generosity in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with no apprehension of a self, no arising of the notion of a sentient being, and no

conceit regarding awakening — that is a miracle. And so it is: moral discipline in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with no movement of body, no utterance of speech, and no stirring of mind — that is a miracle. And so it is: patience in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with no superimposition of craving, with the mind recognized as momentarily disintegrating, and with neither body nor mind engaging in conceptual thought — that is a miracle. And so it is: diligence in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with nothing to take up, nothing to cast away, and nothing to abide in — that is a miracle. And so it is: meditative concentration in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with inner quietude, with no wandering outward, and with no accumulation of mind — that is a miracle. And so it is: wisdom in which the three spheres are utterly purified — with the grasping at "I" fully abandoned, with the clinging to "mine" relinquished, and with freedom from every mode of view — that is a miracle.

All phenomena are without separation, and yet the very speaking of their being separated is itself a miracle. All phenomena are without substantial existence, and yet the very speaking of their being devoid of their own essential nature is itself a miracle. All phenomena are without division, and yet the very speaking that analyzes them through letters and syllables is itself a miracle. All phenomena are without coming and without going, and yet the very speaking of coming and going is itself a miracle. All phenomena are without arising, and yet the very speaking of arising is itself a miracle. All phenomena have but a single realization, and yet the very speaking that sets forth a plurality of fruits is itself a miracle. All phenomena are of but a single taste, and yet the very speaking that sets forth three vehicles is itself a miracle. In the dharmadhātu there is no division whatsoever, and yet the very speaking that sets forth all phenomena as distinct is itself a miracle. All buddhas are but a single buddha, and yet the very speaking of innumerable buddhas is itself a miracle. All buddha-fields are but a single field, and yet the very speaking of manifold buddha-fields is itself a miracle. All sentient beings are but a single sentient being, and yet the very speaking of the gradations of sentient beings is itself a miracle. All phenomena are but a single phenomenon, and yet the very speaking of the lowest, the highest, and the intermediate is itself a miracle. All phenomena are without establishment, and yet the very speaking of the defining characteristics of establishment is itself a miracle. All phenomena are beyond cognition, and yet the very speaking that makes them cognizable to others is itself a miracle.

Then the divine son, the merchant's leader, said this to Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, as I understand the meaning of what you have said, all those phenomena spoken of — every last one of them — are miracles."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Divine son, it is exactly so. Just as was said: because all phenomena are inexpressible, whatever speaking there is concerning them is itself a great miracle."

When this teaching was given, twenty thousand divine sons gave rise to the mind directed toward unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. Five hundred bodhisattvas attained the acceptance of non-arising in phenomena.

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said this to the divine son, the merchant's leader: "Divine son, upon hearing this teaching on miracles, do you not feel afraid?"

The divine son replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, since I myself am a miracle, what reason is there for me to be afraid of it?"

Śāradvatīputra said:

"Divine son, what made you think to say that?"

The divine son replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, since all phenomena are without transition, that which transitions as virtuous and non-virtuous phenomena is itself a great miracle. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the wholesome karma through which I accumulated the actions that caused me to be born among the gods and to attain this very greatness — that I do not think upon, nor do I cognize. And so too the death and rebirth of all sentient beings I do not think upon, nor do I cognize. And whatever is not thought upon and not cognized — that is a great miracle. As the Blessed One himself declared: 'The karmic maturation of karmas is inconceivable. The domain of nāgas is inconceivable. The domain of those in meditative concentration is inconceivable. And the domain of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is inconceivable.' Therefore all phenomena are inconceivable, and whatever is inconceivable is a great miracle."

Then the elder Śāradvatīputra said this: "Divine son, when you hear what the Blessed One taught concerning miracles, do you not feel afraid?"

"Venerable Śāradvatīputra, would the element of space feel afraid at the miracles displayed by a Tathāgata?"

He replied: "Divine son, it would not."

The divine son said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if the element of space would not feel afraid at the miracles displayed by a Tathāgata, then neither would I feel afraid."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Divine son, are you then space?"

The divine son replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I am indeed space."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Divine son, what made you think to say that?"

The divine son replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, is not that very thing which the Blessed One spoke of as the inner element of space, and that which he spoke of as the outer element of space — is that not the element of space?"

He replied: "Divine son, it is."

The divine son said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, therefore all sentient beings too are of the nature of the element of space."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Divine son, just as you have demonstrated, you yourself before long will directly manifest those very miracles."

The divine son replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, those miracles cannot be directly manifested. Why is that? Because those miracles have utterly transcended every domain."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this divine son, the merchant's leader, who teaches in such a way — he must previously have served the Victors of former times and also attended upon Mañjuśrī in his youthful form."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāradvatīputra, it is just so. It is as you have said. Śāradvatīputra, this divine son, the merchant's leader, was matured by Mañjuśrī in his youthful form. Śāradvatīputra, long ago, in the past, more than innumerable and countless eons having passed, there was at that time an eon called Abhirata, in a world system called Sukhāvatī, a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world —"

a tamer of persons yet to be tamed, an unsurpassed charioteer, a teacher of gods and humans — a Tathāgata, a Blessed One, a buddha named Like Mount Meru appeared in the world.

Śāradvatīputra, as for the world system called Sukhāvatī: in that world system, sentient beings dwelt endowed with every happiness, and not even the slightest sound of suffering or mental distress was to be heard. That world

system was composed of four precious substances — gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and crystal. It was level as the palm of a hand, and soft to the touch as the silken cloth of Kāśīlindi. It was free of the lower destinies, thronged entirely with gods and humans; and simply by thinking of food and drink, one obtained them in abundance. It was endowed with immeasurable bliss — and for that reason that world system was called Sukhāvatī, "The Blissful."

The Saṅgha of that Tathāgata consisted exclusively of bodhisattvas: blazing with diligence; having attained the light of wisdom; having attained dhāraṇī and the sovereignty over the sūtras; possessed of inexhaustible eloquence; skilled in the knowledge that fully analyzes and teaches all words; comprehending consciousness through direct knowledge; having decisively vanquished māra and all opponents; endowed with the patient acceptance of the wisdom of unobscured liberation; skilled in administering the medicine of the Dharma in accordance with what is fitting for the mental conduct of all sentient beings; having accumulated the great collections of merit and primordial wisdom; acting as a spiritual friend to all sentient beings without being asked; skilled in the knowledge of traveling through all buddha-fields by means of miraculous power; possessed of mindfulness, intelligence, understanding, a sense of conscience, steadfastness, and a mind that has entered the ocean of wisdom; deeply established in generosity, taming, proper restraint, ethical conduct, learning, and discernment; skilled in fully dedicating roots of virtue by means of limitless methods; deeply entered with superior intent into the powers, the fearlessnesses, and all the qualities of a buddha; bodhisattvas who play exclusively in meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, and the states of meditative composure.

Śāradvatīputra, at that time and in that era, during the proclamation of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, there arose a wheel-turning king named Puṇyavyūha, righteous and a king of Dharma, lord of the four continents, possessed of the seven precious emblems, a lord among humans. He had a full complement of a thousand sons, and every one of them had properly entered into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. King Puṇyavyūha himself, together with his assembly of queens, likewise properly entered into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. The lifespan of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, and the lifespan of those human beings, amounted to seven hundred million years.

Then King Puṇyavyūha, together with his thousand sons and together with the retinue of queens, having attained delight in the Dharma, supreme delight, and faith, attended upon that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, together with his bodhisattva Saṅgha, for a full hundred thousand years, offering according to their wishes robes, food, bedding, seats, medicines for the sick, and all necessities and comforts.

King Puṇyavyūha, together with his retinue, continually and without a single day's interruption personally and reverently offered things directly to that Tathāgata by his own hand, and he also continuously and without interruption engaged in listening to the Dharma. Then, after a hundred thousand years had passed, he together with his sons and the retinue of queens, through repeatedly beholding the buddha and repeatedly hearing the Dharma from him, attained the four recollections. What are those four? Recollection of the buddha, recollection of the Dharma, recollection of the Saṅgha, and recollection of the ethical discipline that is endowed with generosity and does not forget the awakening mind — these four recollections they attained.

Possessed of these four recollections, they were never parted, by day or by night, from beholding the buddha, from rightly examining the Dharma, and from beholding the bodhisattva Saṅgha.

Then at another time, King Puṇyavyūha, together with his sons and the retinue of queens, went to where that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru was dwelling, in order to hear the Dharma. At that time and on that occasion, that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, gave those bodhisattvas instructions by means of many kinds of miraculous displays.

Then King Puṇyavyūha addressed that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, are there other supreme miraculous displays beyond these displays?" When he had said this, that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha named Like Mount Meru, declared to King Puṇyavyūha: "Great King, there are indeed other supreme miraculous displays beyond those. What are they? They are as follows: teaching that mind and mental factors are without form; teaching that mind and mental factors have ceased; speaking of mind and mental factors that have arisen in the

present as being non-abiding; teaching the path that is unborn and unarisen; the single gate of liberation; speaking of it in three parts; expounding the Four Truths in their entirety within the single convergence of realization; the signless; the imageless; fully accomplishing the unconditioned awakening; teaching the phenomena of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness; ripening to full maturity those sentient beings who are constituted by wrong views and mental afflictions; the perfection of generosity applied to phenomena that have nothing to be taken up and nothing to be cast aside; the perfection of ethical discipline applied to phenomena that involve no deliberate formation and no fabrication; the perfection of patience applied to phenomena that have no arising and are momentary; the perfection of diligence applied to phenomena in which body and mind are solitary; the perfection of meditative concentration applied to phenomena that are gathered and free from distraction; the perfection of wisdom applied to phenomena that have neither a far shore nor a near shore; skill in means applied to phenomena that involve no examination and no elimination; cultivating loving-kindness toward phenomena that have no birth and no support; engaging with compassion toward phenomena that have no activity and no destruction; manifestly accomplishing joy in phenomena that are free from attachment;

cultivating equanimity toward phenomena that have no abiding; manifestly accomplishing the divine eye toward phenomena that have no knowing and no seeing; manifestly accomplishing the divine ear toward phenomena that have no hearing and no discernment; having knowledge of others' minds toward phenomena that are free from reference-point and from mind; having knowledge of the recollection of former abodes toward phenomena that are free from any prior limit; attaining the feet of miraculous power toward phenomena that are free from mind, body, sound, and effort; cultivating the close placement of mindfulness toward phenomena that have no abiding; cultivating right abandonment toward phenomena that have no arising and no cessation; demonstrating the faculties toward phenomena that have no faculty; fully proclaiming powers toward phenomena that have no power and are feeble; teaching the limbs of awakening toward phenomena that are close to peace; speaking of the path toward phenomena that have no distinction; generating calm abiding toward phenomena that have gone to the extreme of peace; being skilled in insight toward phenomena whose defining mark is liberation; and speaking of nirvāṇa toward phenomena that are by their very

nature completely passed beyond sorrow.

Thus, that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha, who was like Mount Meru, beginning from that very enumeration of Dharma teachings with which he had displayed miraculous powers to King Virtue Array, to his thousand sons, and to the assembled queens, taught the Dharma in that very way accordingly. And eighty-four thousand living beings gave rise to the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

King Virtue Array and his thousand sons attained the patient acceptance that accords with phenomena. Having attained that patience, by the power of the buddha and by their own confidence, they praised that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha who was like Mount Meru, with these verses:

Just as in the midst of the ocean
the king of mountains stands in beauty,
so in the midst of the Saṅgha
the Dharma King shines resplendent.

Just as the rising of the sun
dispels all darkness,
so the hair-tuft of the buddha too
illuminates the buddha fields.

Just as the full moon of the fifteenth night
shines bright and whole and clear,
so the protector of the world, replete
with buddha-qualities, shines clear and full.

Just as the lotus flower
is unstained within the water,
so the protector of the world too
is unstained by the ways of the world.

Just as the lion, king of the mountain beasts,
sends forth his roar through the forests,
so the lion among men
sends forth the roar of emptiness.

Whether existence or non-existence,
or everything that is existence-and-non-existence —
that which transcends all extreme views

is surely called the lion's roar.

Whether arising or whether ceasing,
those are displayed as characteristics,
yet that which is birthless and without cessation
is surely called the lion's roar.

The far shore and the near shore —
these are taught as conceptual constructs.
That which abides in none of the phenomena
is surely called the lion's roar.

Thorough affliction and complete purification —
these two are without defining mark;
phenomena utterly free from stain
are surely called the lion's roar.

Attachment, aversion, and delusion
arise from conceptual construction;
that which is free from thought and without conception
is surely called the lion's roar.

Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa —
these are led onto the path;
phenomena that are truly compact and gathered
are surely called the lion's roar.

Birth, death, and cyclic existence
arise from erroneous views;

The meaning of impermanence, suffering, and selflessness —
that is surely called the lion's roar.

Views and objects of observation abide,
and by these the world is entered.
That phenomena are taught to be thoroughly empty —
that is surely called the lion's roar.

The miracles displayed by the Protector of the World,
however many and in whatever manner he displayed them —
to teach all of those in their entirety
is surely called the lion's roar.

For the sake of the mind's equanimity,
that which is concordant and that which is discordant —
the mind that does not enter into either of these
is concordant forbearance.

That which accords with what the buddhas have taught,
which is deep and peaceful, which is in harmony,
and which does not dispute with that teaching —
that is concordant forbearance.

Entering into all virtuous phenomena
without exception from among all non-virtues,
yet not abiding even in those —
that is concordant forbearance.

Not being attached to the word "emptiness,"
the word "sentient being," the word "view,"
and not attached to any words whatsoever —
that is concordant forbearance.

Not conceptualizing the word "buddha," the word "affliction,"
the manifold words of the Dharma,
or any word whatsoever —
that is concordant forbearance.

Striving equally in generosity, moral discipline,
learning, diligence, meditative concentration,
and wisdom —
that is concordant forbearance.

Keeping the mind equanimous toward all,
not abandoning the awakening mind,
and revealing the path to awakening —
that is concordant forbearance.

The fully awakened one has taught us
exactly such Dharma;
to have no doubt concerning it —
that is concordant forbearance.

I too shall awaken to buddhahood,
and having proclaimed the lion's roar,
I shall assuredly demonstrate the miracles

of the teaching as shown by the Guide.

This field is inconceivable;
into that supreme field of merit
I have planted seeds,
and therefore I shall not turn back.

All arid ground will be burst open,
and the oceans will be turned to shallows —
yet the seeds I have planted for the fully awakened one
will never be lost.

I seek the minds of sentient beings,
and as vast as the sky can be measured — in an instant —
the merit of the mind dedicated to awakening
is beyond measure.

However my intention may be,
no gods, no gandharvas (celestial musicians),
no other human beings are its witness —
the Blessed One alone is my witness.

O Guide, I seek neither enjoyment, nor form, nor the higher realms.
May I become like whatever the knowledge of you,
O supreme among men, is like.

Having set my sights on awakening,
for a hundred thousand years
without attachment and without aversion
I have served and honored the Sugata.

Those thousand children of mine
and the palace I have fully ripened —
may all of these be made rejoicing
for the sake of the awakening of the buddhas.

I have beheld the Sugata well,
and I have heard this Dharma well,
and I have ever taken joy in awakening —
I have obtained a good obtaining.

Whoever takes joy in awakening
takes constant joy in the Dharma as well;

one who does not abandon phenomena
takes constant joy in all sentient beings.

Then, in that very assembly, there was present a Dharma-teaching monk named Dharmadhvaja, Banner of Dharma, who said the following to King Kuśalavyūha, Radiant Array of Virtue:

Great King, you have not acted in accord with the Tathāgata's miracles; rather, you have acted contrary to them, and thus you abide in what is not the proper abiding. Why is that? Great King, awakening abides in the abiding of the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, and therefore has no entering. Great King, awakening is characterized by the absence of any knowing, because all feeling is absent.

Great King, awakening involves neither taking up nor casting away, and therefore it is without adoption and without rejection. Great King, awakening is like a drawing made in the sky: it is without form, without color, without marks, and without shape. Great King, awakening is utterly pure by its very intrinsic nature, and therefore it has no antidote. Great King, awakening is equal to all phenomena, and therefore it follows after everything. Great King, awakening is free from all signs, and therefore it is without agitation. Great King, awakening has the defining characteristic of thorough peace, and therefore it is peace itself. Great King, awakening is free from analysis and rejection, and therefore it is utter peace. Great King, awakening has no adversary, and therefore it is beyond all wavering. Great King, awakening has nothing fully constructed within it, and therefore the mind is even and undisturbed. Great King, awakening has never arisen from the very beginning, and therefore it is equal to sentient beings. Great King, awakening does not have the defining characteristic of discernment, and therefore, being without arising, it is fully differentiated. Great King, awakening is free from mind, from mentation, and from consciousness, and therefore it is without discernment. Great King, awakening has completely passed beyond all objects, and therefore it does not move about. Great King, awakening is free from all conceptual thought, and therefore it is without conceptual elaboration. Great King, awakening has the defining characteristic of emptiness, and therefore it is empty. Great King, awakening is free from all signs, and therefore it is signless. Great King, awakening is free from aspiration, and therefore it is wishless. Great King, awakening involves no karmic maturation, and therefore it is without volitional construction. Great King, awakening is free from the three defining

characteristics, and therefore it is unconditioned.

Great King, all those who strive toward awakening as though it had such defining characteristics and such an essential nature, who make aspirational prayers toward it, who delight in it, and who desire it — all of them are engaged in mistaken striving. And why is that? Great King, just as awakening is, so too is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Since those who conduct themselves in that very way are those who conduct themselves rightly — that is the reason.

Here ends the second fascicle.

Then King Kuśalavyūha, Radiant Array of Virtue, spoke thus to the Dharma-teaching monk Dharmadhvaja, Banner of Dharma: "Son of good family, be bold in the truly authentic conduct of bodhisattvas."

When he had spoken those words, the Dharma-teaching monk Dharmadhvaja, Banner of Dharma, spoke thus in reply to King Kuśalavyūha, Radiant Array of Virtue:

Great King, the conduct of practicing generosity by relinquishing all possessions through equanimity, without any conceit born of that generosity toward all sentient beings — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of perfectly taking up all the qualities of moral discipline, of training, and of cultivation through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's moral discipline — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of utterly expelling all scorching torment of harsh speech, of anger, of malice, of spite, and of all the scorching torment of aversion through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's patience — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Firm and blazing diligence that knows no despondency, through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's diligence — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's meditative concentration, the conduct of fully embracing meditative concentration, the liberations, and

the absorptions — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's wisdom, fully seeking the accumulation of wisdom that is equanimous — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity free from duality, generating the divine abiding of equanimity — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's higher knowledge, generating higher knowledge — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, with resolute attention to

meaning and to Dharma, entering into the four thorough and correct understandings — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in the unmoving dharmadhātu, taking delight in what is reliable — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, with a mind utterly free from weariness and with resolute attention, perfectly gathering all the qualities conducive to awakening — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity with concordant purpose, perfectly upholding the four means of attraction — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, without making a conceit of one's mind, maintaining an even mind toward all sentient beings — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in the complete purity of space, the complete purity of mind, and the complete purity of the field, perfectly purifying a buddha field — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, examining phenomena as being without defining marks, perfectly gathering the accumulation of the thirty-two major marks — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity of body, speech, and mind, adorning body, speech, and mind — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in the selflessness of all sentient beings, joyfully asking oneself what one can do for all sentient beings — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity, trusting that all things are by nature like a dream, not growing weary of saṃsāra — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity free from attachment to karma and its karmic maturation, performing actions of excellent conduct — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in discerning all phenomena as being like illusions, donning the armor of ascetic observance and austerity — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in knowing that suffering has no arising, enduring all suffering — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity of mind toward friends and non-friends alike, maintaining steadfast affection — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity free from hope of return, applying oneself to elevated intention — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in learning and in practice, seeking learning without ever being satisfied — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in teaching the Dharma without material interest, following the Dharma without need of a teacher's guiding example — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in the solitude of Dharma, perfectly upholding the sacred Dharma — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in the ultimate truth, perfectly seeking the knowledge of truth — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas.

Through equanimity in showing the deepest reverence to all sentient beings, decisively conquering pride — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas. Through equanimity in having perfectly taken up all good qualities, seeking to perfectly gather all good qualities without conceit — that is the conduct of bodhisattvas.

Then King Suvarnavyūha, having heard those accounts of the authentic conduct of bodhisattvas, was filled with joy, delight, gladness, great elation, and happiness at heart. He and his sons, each with the garments and ornaments they wore, covered the Dharma-banner of the Dharma-preaching monk. Those young sons too, each with their own ornaments, covered the Dharma-banner of the Dharma-preaching monk, and spoke these words: "That we have found the opportunity to behold, to pay homage to, and to attend upon a holy man such as this — truly we have found something of great value." And they also said: "May all sentient beings come to attain such conduct and such eloquence as that of this bodhisattva."

Then the Dharma-preaching monk, the Dharma-banner, spoke to King Suvarnavyūha in these words: "Great King, such an offering as this — merely garments and ornaments — is not a great offering. There are other, far superior forms of offering. You should accomplish those. And what are they?" At that moment the Dharma-preaching monk, the Dharma-banner, recited these verses:

All those many thousands of beings
who have entered resolutely upon the path to awakening,
and who, with undaunted minds, throughout a complete aeon,
have given in generosity their sons and their wives —

one who, for the sake of awakening, has aroused the mind,
trains in following the way of the Tathāgata,
and with a mind of renunciation takes even a single step forward —
that one's merit is far superior to all of this.

All the buddhas who have appeared in times past,
all those yet to come and those presently abiding —
none of them, without abandoning the household full of faults,
attained the unsurpassed, peaceful, supreme awakening.

The going forth is praised, lauded, and honored
by all the Tathāgatas.

One who wishes to make offering to all the buddhas
should take up the going forth in the Victor's teaching.

One who dwells at home and adorns a magnificent household,
and gives to buddhahelds as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges —
and one who has gone forth and, through a single day and night,
contemplates impermanence, suffering, and no-self —

one who has gone forth with diligence,
a bodhisattva who is close to awakening,
who has utterly shattered the circle of Māra,
whose side of virtue does not diminish but only grows —

such a renunciant, having abandoned evil paths,
is praised by noble ones who accord with the path.
That one's virtue does not go to waste,
and that one has abandoned all grasping.

Freed from the household, the afflictions do not multiply;
freed from afflictions, there are no bonds of Māra.
A mind fully liberated walks the conduct of awakening;
through pure conduct, awakening is not hard to find.

Then King Suvarṇavyūha, upon hearing those verses, ceased to look with longing upon the joys of desire, his wealth, and the power of kingship, and he became weary of them. Detachment arose in him, his mind inclined toward the going forth, and he addressed the Blessed One, the Tathāgata who stands like Mount Meru, with these words: "Blessed One, may I obtain the going forth and the full ordination in the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya, and attain the full status of a monk?"

The Blessed One, the Tathāgata who stands like Mount Meru, spoke: "Great King, there is no obstacle to the going forth — it is open and available to all sentient beings, and harms no one. Yet to dwell in a household is to dwell in the midst of afflictions. If you wish, I will instruct you and guide you, and you in turn must practice in accordance with that instruction and guidance."

Then the Blessed One opened the way of the going forth. King Suvarṇavyūha addressed those thousand sons of his: "Which of you is eager to carry on the work of kingship and to guide sentient beings in the embrace of true Dharma?" All of them replied: "Father, we too, out of faith, wish to go forth from home into homelessness. Please do not abandon us." The king said: "If all of you go forth, every gathering of people in the world systems of all four continents will be utterly ruined. Therefore, whichever one of you is most moved by firm great

compassion for sentient beings — let that one carry on the work of kingship and lead sentient beings in the embrace of true Dharma."

Then from among those young princes, the one known as Mahākaruṇāmati — Young Prince Greatly Minded with Compassion — addressed his father and the eldest among them in verse:

The Tathāgatas have taught that the going forth
accumulates many virtues — this is true.

Yet moved as I am by compassion,

I shall carry on the work of kingship for the benefit of beings.

As long as I live, I shall live in celibacy

and shall observe the eight-limbed precepts of the restoration ceremony.

Flowers and perfumes and unguents,

and likewise fermented drink — I shall not partake of these.

I shall wear no ornaments upon my body,

seek no fine sandals, and wear no jeweled crown.

I shall not sleep upon a couch with legs of gold,

nor shall I seek the garments befitting a king.

I shall take no delight in the sounds of music and song,

nor shall I rejoice in the calls of peacocks or geese.

When people are arrayed before me, I shall shun the company of women

and lie alone on my bed, sheltered from the wind.

I shall travel from continent to continent

and proclaim the ten virtuous actions.

I shall show the faults of dwelling in a household

and also speak the praises of the going forth.

On account of pride in beauty, wealth, and power,

I shall not neglect the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha,

nor shall I fail to arouse the awakening mind.

With a mind ever inspired with weariness of the three realms, I shall engage in them.

Through generosity, pleasing speech, purposeful conduct, and consistency of aim —

the four means of gathering — I shall strive to draw sentient beings together,

and within this supreme and holy Great Vehicle

I shall bring countless living beings to full maturity.

That I may hear and expound the meaning of Dharma,
three times each day and three times each night
I shall come into the presence of the one who stands like Mount Meru
and offer worship to the Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata who stands like Mount Meru, praised Young Prince Mahākaruṇāmati, saying: "Excellent! Excellent! Noble one, excellent! Because of the virtuous quality of having perfectly received the moral discipline of the eight trainings, a bodhisattva who remains a householder is equal in virtue to one who has gone forth. Through your great compassion you also accomplish the virtues accomplished by the going forth."

Thereupon King Suvarṇavyūha installed Young Prince Mahākaruṇāmati upon the throne of the kingdom. Then, accompanied by his remaining nine hundred and ninety-nine sons, with faith in the teachings of that Blessed One, he went forth from home into homelessness.

After they had gone forth, that Tathāgata, through these very miraculous displays, gave them instruction and guidance in this way and that, and before long they all developed the five superknowledges (abhijñā). They also developed dhāraṇī, mindfulness, and the wisdom of hearing the Dharma.

Young Prince Mahākaruṇāmati, having been installed upon the throne of the kingdom, each month would go out teaching throughout the four great continents, and in this way he taught the Dharma to sentient beings so that nine hundred and seventy thousand and two hundred million beings would arouse the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Every one of those beings, inspired by faith in the teachings of that Blessed One — that Tathāgata who is like Mount Meru — went forth from home into homelessness, and through this Great Vehicle became entirely irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Son of Śāradvatī, look to that scripture in which beings who gave rise to roots of virtue and who purified themselves arose as a support for one another and gave rise to faith — to whatever extent that was the case. Son of Śāradvatī, if you should think with hesitation and doubt that the wheel-turning king named Suvarṇavyūha at that time and on that occasion was someone else, you should not look at it that way. It was this very caravan leader, the son of a god, who at that time and on that occasion was the wheel-turning king named Suvarṇavyūha.

Son of Śāradvatī, if you should think with hesitation and doubt that the Dharma-preaching monk named Dharmaketu at that time and on that occasion was someone else, you should not look at it that way. It was this very Mañjuśrī, in his youthful form, who at that time and on that occasion was the Dharma-preaching monk named Dharmaketu.

Son of Śāradvatī, if you should think with hesitation and doubt that the full thousand sons of King Suvarṇavyūha at that time and on that occasion were others, you should not look at it that way. The thousand buddhas of this very present Fortunate Aeon (bhadrakalpa) were, at that time and on that occasion, the full thousand sons of King Suvarṇavyūha.

Son of Śāradvatī, if you should think with hesitation and doubt that the Young Prince named Mahākaruṇāmati at that time and on that occasion was someone else, you should not look at it that way. It was I myself who at that time and on that occasion was Young Prince Mahākaruṇāmati.

Son of Śāradvatī, thus it is that heedful bodhisattvas of former times, through their elevated intention and their conduct of vigilant awareness, do indeed emerge into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

When the Blessed One taught this tale of former virtuous conduct, thirty-two thousand beings from among the multitude of gods and humans gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the venerable son of Śāradvatī said to Mañjuśrī in youthful form the following: "Mañjuśrī, you have long practiced the holy life together with this son of a god, the caravan leader, and have served many buddhas and given rise to roots of virtue."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable son of Śāradvatī, the term 'holy life' is merely a designating phrase from the noble eightfold path, and the path is a conditioned thing.

I belong to what is unconditioned, and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is a defining characteristic of conduct, yet I am one who has no conduct and no supreme conduct — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' involves engagement in duality, yet I neither engage in duality nor engage in non-duality — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is the antidote to afflictions, yet I am not one who is thoroughly separated

by an antidote — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is withdrawal from forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangible objects, and mental phenomena, yet I am not withdrawn from forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangible objects, and mental phenomena — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is a thorough crossing beyond the path of māra, yet I am not one who thoroughly crosses beyond the path of māra — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is the totality of spiritual friends, yet I do not commit myself definitively to virtue or to non-virtue — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is the attainment of the faultlessness of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, yet I am not one who attains the faultlessness of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is withdrawal from saṃsāra, yet I am not withdrawn from saṃsāra — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life. Venerable son of Śāradvatī, what is called 'the holy life' is proceeding on the path to nirvāṇa, yet I am not one who seeks nirvāṇa — and therefore I have not long practiced the holy life.

Venerable son of Śāradvatī, as for what you said — 'Mañjuśrī, you have served many buddhas' — a Tathāgata cannot be served. Why is that? Because a Tathāgata has no form and is not demonstrable, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has no feeling and all streams of feeling are cut, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has no perception and is free from all the knots of perception, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has no formations and has attained the unconditioned, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has no consciousness and no abiding of mind, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the eye and of visible form, but is the domain of emptiness, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the ear and of sound, but is the domain of the signless, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the nose and of smell, but is free from duality, he cannot be served.

Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the tongue and of taste, but has the characteristic of being beyond all discriminating cognition, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the body and of tangible things, but has the characteristic of being unobstructed, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is not an object of the mind and of mental phenomena,

but is perfectly gathered into the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata abides in suchness, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has entered into accord with the ultimate limit of reality, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is utterly distinguished by the dharmadhātu, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has entered into great emptiness, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is the equanimity of intrinsic nature, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has perfectly severed all conceptual elaboration, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata has entered into the objectless, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata does not abide in consciousness, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata does not abide in the three realms, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is without defilement, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata does not abide in this world or in the world beyond, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is pacified, utterly pacified, and thoroughly at peace, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is free from body, speech, and mind, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is free from color, form, and shape, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata is nowhere to be disparaged and is without any fault anywhere, he cannot be served. Because a Tathāgata does not truly abide in any mode of conduct, he cannot be served. And, venerable Śāradvatīputra, because a Tathāgata is nowhere to be imputed upon and is like something drawn in space, he cannot be served.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, as for what you said — that Mañjuśrī has generated a root of virtue — venerable Śāradvatīputra, that which is not rooted in the view of the transitory collection, not rooted in ignorance and craving for existence, not rooted in attachment, aversion, and delusion, not rooted in the four inversions, not rooted in the five aggregates, not rooted in the six sense sources, not rooted in the seven stations of consciousness, not rooted in the eight wrong factors, not rooted in the nine objects of vexation, not rooted in the nine abodes of sentient beings, and not rooted in the ten paths of non-virtuous action — that indeed is a root of virtue.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that which is not rooted in attachment to the one-way path, not rooted in the conceptual examination of knowledge and liberation, not rooted in conceit regarding the higher training in moral discipline, the higher training of mind, and the higher training in wisdom, not rooted in the conceptual examination of the Four Truths, not rooted in the perception of the five faculties as such, not rooted in taking the six

superknowledges as an object, not rooted in superimposition regarding the seven branches of awakening,

not rooted in conceit regarding the noble eightfold path, not rooted in generating views toward the nine successive meditative absorptions (samāpattis), not rooted in attachment to the ten qualities of one who is beyond training — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in the māra of the aggregates, not rooted in the māra of the afflictions, not rooted in the māra of the Lord of Death, not rooted in the māra of the divine son — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in obscurations, not rooted in collapse and agitation, not rooted in remorse — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in the view of self, not rooted in the view of a sentient being, not rooted in the view of a life principle, not rooted in the view of a nourisher, not rooted in the view of a person — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in the view of arising, not rooted in the view of perishing, not rooted in the view of annihilation, not rooted in the view of permanence — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in the improper, not rooted in ignorance, not rooted in formations, not rooted in consciousness, not rooted in name-and-form, not rooted in the six sense bases, not rooted in contact, not rooted in feeling, not rooted in craving, not rooted in grasping, not rooted in becoming, not rooted in birth, not rooted in aging-and-death, not rooted in sickness, suffering, mental unhappiness, and disturbance — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in the desire realm, not rooted in the form realm, not rooted in the formless realm — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in conceit regarding generosity, not rooted in conceit regarding moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom — that indeed is a root of virtue.

That which is not rooted in conceit regarding loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva.

That which is not rooted in seeking the way of the śrāvaka or the pratyekabuddha — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva.

That which is rooted in great loving-kindness and great compassion, rooted in never abandoning the mind of omniscience, rooted in bringing all sentient

beings to complete maturation, rooted in upholding the sacred Dharma, rooted in relinquishing all possessions, rooted in having no hope for karmic maturation, rooted in perfectly taking up all moral discipline and training, rooted in not desiring even the station of Śakra, Brahmā, or the World-Protectors, rooted in patience, peace, taming, and contentment, rooted in doing harm to neither oneself nor others, rooted in taking up great and steadfast diligence, rooted in not accumulating inferior qualities, rooted in meditative concentration yet not savoring the taste of meditative concentration, rooted in wisdom yet also rooted in equanimity, rooted in skillful means, rooted in following the way of all — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva.

That which is rooted in not cutting the continuity of the Three Jewels, rooted in the ten powers and fearlessness, rooted in perfectly accomplishing all the qualities of a buddha — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva. The body and...

speech, and mind — that which is the continuity of the root of virtue is indeed a root of virtue of a bodhisattva.

That which is rooted in attaining the knowledge of dhāraṇī — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva. That which is rooted in eloquence that cannot be interrupted — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva. That which is rooted in attaining the superknowledges and the sciences — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva. That which is rooted in perfectly purifying the buddha fields — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva. That which is rooted in blessing beings who go to the seat of awakening, and that which is rooted in turning the wheel of Dharma in its twelve aspects by proclaiming it three times — that indeed is a root of virtue of a bodhisattva.

When Mañjuśrī in his youthful form had spoken these three definitive teachings on the basis of meaning, the entire assembly responded with "Excellent!" and then scattered flowers of many varieties before the Blessed One and before Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, saying these words: "Know that in whatever buddha field Mañjuśrī in his youthful form abides, two Tathāgatas have arisen there. Those sentient beings who, upon hearing this teaching given by Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, do not become afraid, do not become fearful, and will not be made to tremble — they are not ones endowed with inferior roots of virtue. They have blocked all the deeds of Māra. They have attained illumination in this Great Vehicle." So did they speak.

Then the Blessed One, rejoicing at what the entire assembly had said, declared these words to the son of the gods (deva), the caravan leader: "Son of the gods, that anyone who hears what Mañjuśrī in his youthful form has taught should come to have faith — that too is a great miracle. Such persons will not be frightened by any other miracles whatsoever. And why is that? Son of the gods, consider this: to teach impermanence to sentient beings who perceive things as permanent; to teach suffering to those who perceive things as pleasurable; to teach selflessness to those who perceive a self; to teach unattractiveness to those who perceive things as attractive; to teach the absence of things to those who perceive things as existing; to teach emptiness to those who perceive a fixed standpoint; to teach signlessness to those who perceive signs; to teach wishlessness to those who perceive the three realms; and to teach freedom from all views to those who perceive 'I' and 'mine' — this is a great terror for the world. Those who do not become afraid before it are truly tamed, and the reason is that those who are truly tamed do not become afraid before anything.

And why is that? Because those factors from which fear would arise — namely, fully grasping at 'I' and fully grasping at 'mine' — have not been fully grasped by such persons. Where there is no full grasping, there is no basis of support. Where there is no basis of support, there is no wavering. Where there is no wavering, there is no agitation. Where there is no agitation, there is no taking up. Where there is no taking up, there is no discarding. Where there is no discarding, there is no holding. Where there is no holding, there is no extreme holding. Where there is no extreme holding, there is no inversion. Where there is no inversion, there is no erroneousness itself. Freedom from erroneousness is right accomplishment. Right accomplishment is right view. And right view — right view is the very interval leading to right meditative absorption. In right meditative absorption, there is no distraction. In the undistracted mind, there is no dwelling. In the undwelling mind, there is no abiding. In the absence of the mind's abiding, there is no abiding place for consciousness. Where there is no cognitive awareness, there is no examination and no dismissal. Through freedom from examination and dismissal, reference-objects are abandoned. In dwelling without reference-objects, there is no obscuration. In dwelling without obscuration, there is no conceit. Where there is no conceit, there is no heightened conceit. Where there is no heightened conceit, there is no seeing of self and other. In that absence, there is no burning torment. Where there is no burning torment, there is no despondency. Where there is no despondency,

there is no cause for affliction. In a mind free from affliction, there is luminous appearance. Through gaining that luminosity, one sees wisdom. In the mind that abides in seeing wisdom, awareness of mind becomes vast. In abiding in that vast awareness of mind, māra finds no opening. In decisively defeating māra and all adversaries, freedom from obscuration is made manifest. And in abiding in freedom from obscuration, all the qualities of a buddha are made fully manifest. This, O son of the gods, is itself the great miracle — to demonstrate in this way the sequential connection of Dharma for phenomena that are unmade and unborn.

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said this to Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful: "In whatever we ask Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, from within the very words of each question, all the qualities of a buddha shine forth."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena have no master; they accomplish whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are inexhaustible; they teach whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are inert; they express whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena do not remain fixed; they arrange whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are without visible form; they display whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are equanimous; they explain whatever is desired. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, these phenomena were not taken up from anywhere, nor carried to anywhere; they are neither accumulated nor heaped together. Whether spoken of or not spoken of, the suchness of phenomena is not abandoned.

Whatever letters arise for all sentient beings, and whatever letters arise in the teaching of Dharma by all buddhas — all those letters did not arise from the body, nor did they arise from the mind; they arose from causes and conditions alone. Just as there is no accumulation in letters, so too there is no accumulation in mind and mental phenomena. Just as there is no accumulation in mind and mental phenomena, so too there is no accumulation in all reference-objects of affliction. Just as there is no accumulation in all reference-objects of affliction, so too there is no accumulation in the cognition by which afflictions are abandoned —

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that too — the abandonment of non-abiding afflictions by means of a non-abiding cognition — is a great miracle.

Then the son of a god who was a caravan leader spoke these words to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form: "Mañjuśrī, what is the cognition of bodhisattvas?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of a god, it is the cognition that fully knows suffering; the cognition that, having fully abandoned the aggregates, feels no weariness toward them; the cognition that knows the origin; the cognition that knows the gathering together of virtuous roots; the cognition that knows cessation; the cognition that knows arising; the cognition that knows manifestation; the cognition that knows the path; the cognition that knows the cutting off of wrong paths; the cognition that knows the cause; the cognition that knows what is not wasted; the cognition that knows the result; the cognition that knows the abandonment of what is to be directly realized; the cognition that knows conditions; the cognition that knows the accumulation of collections; the cognition that knows the truths; the cognition that knows how to look upon and attain the primordial wisdom of the buddhas; the cognition that knows dependent origination; the cognition that knows non-attachment to manifestation; the cognition that knows the aggregates; the cognition that knows the abandonment of the māra of the aggregates; the cognition that knows the elements; the cognition that knows the indivisibility of the dharmadhātu; the cognition that knows the sense bases; the cognition that discerns them as like an empty village; the cognition that knows generosity; the cognition that knows not to transgress what is timely and what is untimely; the cognition that knows moral discipline; the cognition that knows how to fully ripen sentient beings whose moral discipline has degenerated; the cognition that knows patience; the cognition that knows how to protect sentient beings; the cognition that knows diligence; the cognition that knows how to perform well-made actions; the cognition that knows meditative concentration; the cognition that knows withdrawal from meditative concentration; the cognition that knows wisdom; the cognition that fully knows views; the cognition that knows skillful means; the cognition that knows how to fully ripen sentient beings; the cognition that knows loving-kindness; the cognition that knows how to protect sentient beings; the cognition that knows compassion; the cognition that knows inexhaustible freedom from weariness; the cognition that knows joy; the cognition that knows delight, deep delight, and supreme delight in the Dharma; the cognition that knows equanimity; the cognition that knows how to fully accomplish the qualities of a buddha; the cognition that knows how to introduce sentient beings; the cognition that knows conventional expressions; the cognition that knows the close

placements of mindfulness; the cognition that knows abiding in what has no abiding-place; the cognition that knows the thorough relinquishments; the cognition that knows non-contradiction with equality; the cognition that knows the bases of miraculous power; the cognition that discerns without conceptual elaboration; the cognition that knows the faculty of faith and its power, and knows how to pass completely beyond all attachment; the cognition that knows the faculty of diligence and its power, and knows how to remain unassailed by all afflictions; the cognition that knows the faculty of mindfulness and its power, and knows the non-forgetting of all phenomena; the cognition that knows the faculty of meditative absorption and its power, and knows the equality of all phenomena; the cognition that knows the faculty of wisdom and its power, and knows the superior and inferior faculties of all sentient beings; the cognition that knows the branches of awakening; the cognition that knows the realization of self-arisen gnosis; the cognition that knows the path; the cognition that knows how to pass completely beyond all wrong paths; the cognition that knows the superior focus of great compassion; the cognition that knows exhaustion; the cognition that knows the inexhaustibility of all virtuous roots; the cognition that knows non-arising; the cognition that knows the attainment of patient acceptance of the birthless nature of phenomena; the cognition that knows the recollection of the buddhas; the cognition that knows the full accomplishment of a buddha's body; the cognition that knows the recollection of the Dharma; the cognition that knows the thorough turning of the wheel of Dharma; the cognition that knows the recollection of the Saṅgha; the cognition that knows the true assembly of irreversible bodhisattvas; the cognition that knows the recollection of giving; the cognition that knows the non-abandonment of all sentient beings; the cognition that knows the recollection of moral discipline; the cognition that knows the complete fulfillment of all aspirational prayers;

the cognition that knows the recollection of the gods; the cognition that knows the avoidance of all evil; the cognition that knows the faculties of sentient beings; the cognition that knows the sequential understanding of progression; the cognition that knows how to bring the accumulation of learning to complete fulfillment; the cognition that knows the insatiability of all accumulations; the cognition that knows all remedies; the cognition that knows how to apply them in accordance with conditions as they are; the cognition that knows what is possible and what is impossible; the cognition that knows the avoidance of what is impossible; the cognition that knows the

ten powers; the cognition that knows the vehicle in accord with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas; the cognition that knows fearlessness; the cognition that knows, through understanding of phenomena, what is an obstruction and what is not an obstruction; the cognition that is unobstructed with respect to the past; the cognition that knows consciousness as not abiding; the cognition that is unobstructed with respect to the future; the cognition that knows the true non-transgression of all phenomena; the cognition that is unobstructed with respect to what arises in the present; the cognition that knows non-abiding and the absence of fixed dwelling; the cognition that knows body as the forerunner; the cognition that knows how to enter into the bodies of all sentient beings; the cognition that knows speech as the forerunner; the cognition that knows the full differentiation of the sounds of all sentient beings; the cognition that knows mind as the forerunner; the cognition that knows, through understanding, the fluctuating conduct of the minds of all sentient beings; the cognition free of confusion; the cognition that knows, through understanding, the confusion of all sentient beings; the cognition free of mental afflictions; the cognition that knows how to pacify the mental afflictions and disputes of all sentient beings; the cognition that is unforgetting; the cognition that knows how to establish distracted sentient beings in mindfulness; the cognition that fully grasps intention; the cognition that knows how to fully embrace lazy sentient beings; the cognition that knows the unshared qualities of a buddha; the cognition that knows, through understanding, how to discipline those sentient beings who are to be disciplined; the cognition that knows skillful means; and the cognition that knows wisdom.

Son of the gods, these are the cognitions of a bodhisattva. A bodhisattva endowed with these cognitions attains the unattached primordial wisdom of a buddha.

The son of the gods spoke: Mañjuśrī, how inconceivable is the cognition of bodhisattvas, and how wondrous is that cognition which is supremely elevated above the entirety of all three worlds! That cognition cannot be fully gathered in by one who wears inferior armor.

Mañjuśrī, moreover, the very fact of generating such a cognition is itself a great miraculous display.

This is the third and final section.

Mañjuśrī, in what way is a bodhisattva well-armored?

Mañjuśrī spoke: Son of the gods, when a bodhisattva does not become frightened at the prospect of sentient beings who are by their very nature completely beyond sorrow — such a bodhisattva is one who is well-armored.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called bodhisattvas?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they enter into the abode of awakening, they are called bodhisattvas.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called great beings?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they bring great undertakings to complete fulfillment and bring great primordial wisdom to full perfection, they are called great beings.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called supreme among sentient beings?

He replied: Son of the gods, because through wisdom they enter into phenomena without anything to be apprehended, and through skillful means they fully embrace all phenomena — for these reasons they are called supreme among sentient beings.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called pure sentient beings?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they do not abide together with the stains of mental afflictions, and because they also apply diligence for the sake of abandoning the mental afflictions of all sentient beings — for these reasons they are called pure sentient beings.

He was asked:

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called pure sentient beings?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they purify the path of definite emergence for all sentient beings — for this reason they are called pure sentient beings.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called guides?

He replied: Son of the gods, because, abiding on that path, they bring immeasurable and incalculable numbers of sentient beings to full maturation — for this reason they are called guides.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, why are they called excellent guides?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they establish those sentient beings who are to be tamed in the most thorough training — for this reason they are called

excellent guides.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva courageous?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as, in order to definitively vanquish māras and adversaries and to bring sentient beings to full maturation, they take rebirth in existence — to that extent is a bodhisattva courageous.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva difficult to subdue?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they fulfil their former vows and their former intentions, and therefore do not yield to desire for the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — this is how they are difficult to subdue.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva supremely noble?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they are present everywhere for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturation and upholding the sacred Dharma through noble wisdom and skillful means — to that extent is a bodhisattva supremely noble.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva a Dharma speaker?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as, through the words embraced by the buddhas, they overwhelm the evil speech of all sentient beings — this is how they are a Dharma speaker.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva a speaker of Vinaya?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as, while themselves abiding in moral discipline, they teach the Dharma in order to remove the remorse and agitation of all sentient beings — this is how they are a speaker of Vinaya.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva a speaker of meaning?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they make all that is heard into something essential and follow through in understanding its meaning — this is how they are a speaker of meaning.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva an excellent foundation of benefit for all sentient beings?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they dedicate to sentient beings all the wholesome roots they have properly accomplished — this is how they are an excellent foundation of benefit for all sentient beings.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva upright?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they do not conceal their own faults — this is how they are upright.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva noble?

He replied: Son of the gods, because they do not become angry with sentient beings who are entangled in attachment, aversion, and delusion — for this reason they are noble.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva without deceit?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they do not transgress the words they have spoken — this is how they are without deceit.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva without guile?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they speak in words exactly as they intend in their mind — this is how they are without guile.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva without pride?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they bow to all sentient beings and do not engage in non-virtue — this is how they are without pride.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva a lord of generosity?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they give away even their accumulated awakening — what need is there to speak of other things?

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with moral discipline?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as when they see another's breach of moral discipline, they do not abandon the awakening mind even to save their own life — this is how they are endowed with moral discipline.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who speaks of patience?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they endure harm done to themselves while doing no harm to others — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with diligence?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as when they examine thoroughly, they do not apprehend even a single phenomenon — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who meditates in meditative concentration?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they do not appear again in the desire realm — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with wisdom?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they do not make wisdom into an object of activity — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who abides in loving-kindness?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they view the realm of sentient beings as emptiness — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who abides in compassion?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they understand all phenomena to be like space and yet do not abandon their diligence toward awakening — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who abides in joy?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as, having attained calm and utter tranquility, they are never satiated with joy in the thorough pursuit of the Dharma — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who abides in equanimity?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as, though they move about in the world in order to fully protect sentient beings, they are not seized by the phenomena of the world — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one whose body is wholly pure?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as by means of a mind-born body they manifest in accordance with the bodies of all sentient beings — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one whose speech is wholly pure?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they teach the Dharma fruitfully, perfectly fulfilling all the voices of all sentient beings — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one whose mind is wholly pure?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as through a single mind they fully know the minds of all sentient beings — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva endowed with the divine eye?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they see all visible appearances and yet also reveal that form is empty of inherent existence — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who has attained the divine ear?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they hear all sounds and yet also reveal that sound is empty of inherent existence — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva skilled in knowing the minds of others?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they fully know the continuum of the minds of those whose mental arisings have ceased — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva skilled in knowledge of former abodes?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they recollect the full extent of the past limit and yet do not waver from the true limit — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who knows how to perform miracles?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they can display all māras and yet are not tainted by the deeds of māra — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who is tamed?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they tame those who are untamed — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who is guarded?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as all the sense faculties are undistracted — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who is thoroughly tamed?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they have become a phenomenon that is unperturbed — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who is peaceful?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as they are not tormented by any of the torments of the mental afflictions, and yet they teach the Dharma for the sake of removing the afflictions of all sentient beings — this is how they are so.

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who has faith?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as even when tested by the physical form of a buddha's body, they are not shaken — this is how they are so.

He was asked:

He was asked: Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva one who is skilled in skillful means?

He replied: Son of the gods, insofar as the bodhisattva sees every sentient being as dependent upon awakening — this is how they are so.

When this teaching was given, twelve thousand living beings aroused the mind directed toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Five hundred bodhisattvas attained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).

Then the Blessed One praised Mañjuśrī, the youthful, saying: Excellent! Mañjuśrī, excellent, excellent! You have well spoken the names of the bodhisattvas and the qualities of those noble beings — and beyond these there are still immeasurably many more.

Then the son of the gods, the caravan leader, spoke further to Mañjuśrī, the youthful, saying: Mañjuśrī, however many Tathāgatas you have attended and served in the past, you must possess a boldness such as this.

Mañjuśrī replied: Son of the gods, I have done so for as many as the number of minds and mental factors that have ceased in an illusory being who is not an emanation.

He said: Mañjuśrī, if even in an emanation itself there are no minds and mental factors, what need is there to speak of one who is not an emanation?

He replied: Son of the gods, those Tathāgatas too have a defining mark of that very same essential nature, and the defining mark of attending and serving them is likewise of that same kind.

He said: Mañjuśrī, for how long a time have you practised the perfection of generosity?

He replied: Son of the gods, if you were to ask an emanation of a Tathāgata how long it had practised the perfection of generosity, would that emanation give an answer?

He said: Mañjuśrī, it would not give any answer whatsoever.

He replied: Son of the gods, since I too have the defining mark of just such an emanation, one should answer me accordingly — saying that I have practised the perfection of generosity for such and such a length of time.

He said: Mañjuśrī, then are you a miser?

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — I am a miser.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one who does not relinquish anything a miser?

He said: Mañjuśrī, what do you not relinquish?

He replied: Son of the gods, I do not relinquish all the qualities of a buddha, nor do I relinquish all sentient beings — and therefore I am a miser.

He said: Mañjuśrī, as I understand the meaning of what you have said, you are one whose moral discipline is broken.

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — my moral discipline is broken.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one whose moral discipline is broken someone who falls into the three lower realms?

He said: Mañjuśrī, that is so.

He replied: Son of the gods, I too go intentionally into the lower realms for the sake of ripening sentient beings — and therefore my moral discipline is broken.

He said: Mañjuśrī, do you possess a mind of ill will?

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — I possess a mind of ill will.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one who possesses a mind of ill will someone who has no attachment?

He said: Mañjuśrī, that is so.

He replied: Son of the gods, I have no attachment whatsoever toward all afflictions, toward all childish beings, toward śrāvakas, and toward pratyekabuddhas — and therefore I possess a mind of ill will.

He said: Mañjuśrī, are you lazy?

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — I am lazy.

He said:

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one who is called lazy someone who does not strive with body, speech, or mind? I too do not strive, I do not pursue, I do not take up, and I do not cast away — and therefore I am lazy.

He said: Mañjuśrī, is your mind distracted?

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — my mind is distracted.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one whose mind does not abide in liberation a person whose mind is distracted?

He said: Mañjuśrī, that is so.

He replied: Son of the gods, I too do not let my mind abide in the liberation of the noble ones, and I remain with a distracted mind for the sake of bringing all sentient beings to full maturation — and therefore my mind is distracted.

He said: Mañjuśrī, is your wisdom deranged?

He replied: Son of the gods, that is so — my wisdom is deranged.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, is not one who is unafraid of saṃsāra and who delights in dwelling together with bewildered sentient beings a person whose wisdom is deranged?

He said: Mañjuśrī, that is so.

He replied: Son of the gods, I too am unafraid of saṃsāra, and I delight in dwelling together with bewildered sentient beings for the sake of bringing them to full maturation — and therefore my wisdom is deranged.

He said: Mañjuśrī, who in this world are worthy recipients of offerings?

He replied: Son of the gods, those who give rise to the intention of slaying what is to be slain.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, what are called "those to be slain" are attachment, aversion, and delusion — and one who slays them is one who

slays what is to be slain, and therefore such a one is a worthy recipient of offerings in this world.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what you have taught would alarm those who abide in the world.

He replied: Son of the gods, if the ultimate limit of reality were something alarming, then those who abide in the world would indeed be alarmed. But why is that not so? Because the world itself abides in the ultimate limit of reality.

He said: Mañjuśrī, where will those who abandon what you have taught here go?

He replied: Son of the gods, they will go to nirvāṇa.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, without abandoning the sound of another's voice, one is unable to attain the noble liberation. Why is that? Because for one who has entered the faultless state, there is no access through letters — and therefore those who become attracted to letters will not be liberated.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what leads you to say such a thing?

He replied: Son of the gods, liberation will not become liberation again.

He said: Mañjuśrī, those who abandon the sublime Dharma go to the hells.

He replied: Son of the gods, will all those who attain liberation then go to the hells?

He said: Mañjuśrī, the Dharma you have taught is without antidote.

He replied: Son of the gods, one cannot speak of an antidote to emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness.

He said: Mañjuśrī, one who abides in emptiness — in what do they abide?

He replied: Son of the gods, one who abides in emptiness abides in loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. Why is that? Because emptiness does not exist apart from sentient beings.

He said: Mañjuśrī, how does a bodhisattva come to fully comprehend the extent of the realm of sentient beings?

He replied:

Son of the gods, when a bodhisattva sees that all sentient beings arise through dependent origination, and does not fall into the extremes of either permanence or annihilation in regard to that, this is what it means for a bodhisattva to have fully comprehended the extent of the realm of sentient beings.

He said: Mañjuśrī, with what element is the realm of sentient beings endowed?

He replied: Son of the gods, the realm of sentient beings is endowed with the element of the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena.

He said: Mañjuśrī, with what element is the dharmadhātu endowed?

He replied: Son of the gods, it is endowed with the element whose essential nature is space.

He said: Mañjuśrī, with what element is the element of space endowed?

He replied: Son of the gods, it is endowed with the element that has perfectly transcended all objects.

He said: Mañjuśrī, what domain is the domain of a buddha?

He replied: Son of the gods, the domain of the eye is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the eye, of form, and of consciousness. The domain of the ear is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the ear, of sound, and of consciousness. The domain of the nose is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the nose, of smell, and of consciousness. The domain of the tongue is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the tongue, of taste, and of consciousness. The domain of the body is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the body, of tangible objects, and of consciousness. The domain of mind is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of mind, of mental phenomena, and of consciousness.

The domain of form is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is amenable to form. The domain of feeling is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is experienced. The domain of perception is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is subject to all-pervasive fluctuation. The domain of formations is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is subject

to active conditioning. The domain of consciousness is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is subject to discriminative awareness.

The domain of ignorance is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of cause and condition. The domain extending through old age and death is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is linked through the joining of continuity.

The domain of the desire realm is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the distinct discernment of desire and attachment. The domain of the form realm is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of the antidote to desire and attachment. The domain of the formless realm is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of liberation from views.

The domain of the unconditioned element is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is joined in duality. The domain of the conditioned element is the domain of a buddha — and yet the domain of a buddha is not the domain of what is characterized by the three defining marks.

Son of the gods, that is the domain of a buddha — for it is the domain of what is the extreme and what is not the extreme, and in that domain all domains are gathered and encompassed.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva who has entered such a domain, and who moves through all objects of meaning, has not attained the domain of māra. For that bodhisattva has fully and perfectly comprehended the domain of māra and the domain of a buddha as equal and as a domain of solitude.

Son of the gods, one who, through equanimity and non-equanimity, brings sentient beings to full maturation, yet never departs from equanimity itself — this too is a great wonder.

Now, what is equanimity and what is non-equanimity? It is as follows. That all phenomena are equal in emptiness — this is equanimity. Those who do not enter into emptiness abide in non-equanimity. Yet the bodhisattva brings those very beings to full maturation without ever stirring from the equanimity of emptiness. That all phenomena are equal in signlessness — this is equanimity. Those who do not enter into that equanimity abide in non-equanimity. Yet the bodhisattva brings those very beings to full

maturation without ever stirring from the equanimity of signlessness. That all phenomena are equal in wishlessness — this is equanimity. Those who do not enter into that equanimity abide in non-equanimity. Yet the bodhisattva brings those very beings to full maturation without ever stirring from the equanimity of wishlessness. That all phenomena are equal in the absence of volitional construction — this is equanimity. Those who do not enter into that equanimity abide in non-equanimity. Yet the bodhisattva brings those very beings to full maturation without ever stirring from the equanimity of the absence of volitional construction. That all phenomena are equal in non-arising, equal in non-origination, equal in non-cessation, equal in being free from attachment, equal in solitude, equal in the absence of any thing, equal in cessation, and that all phenomena are equal in nirvāṇa — this is equanimity. Those who do not enter into that equanimity abide in non-equanimity. Yet the bodhisattva brings those very beings to full maturation without ever stirring from the equanimity of nirvāṇa.

Son of the gods, a bodhisattva who moves through both equanimity and non-equanimity in this way is one who moves through the conduct of a bodhisattva.

Then the son of the gods, the caravan leader, spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, please give expression to the conduct of bodhisattvas."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, the conduct of bodhisattvas is inconceivable."

He said: "Mañjuśrī, in what way is the conduct of bodhisattvas inconceivable?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Son of the gods, because the conduct of attachment is inconceivable, the conduct of bodhisattvas too is inconceivable — but it is not the conduct of one free from attachment. Because the conduct of aversion is inconceivable, the conduct of bodhisattvas too is inconceivable — but it is not the conduct of one free from aversion. Because the conduct of delusion is inconceivable, the conduct of bodhisattvas too is inconceivable — but it is not the conduct of one who accomplishes the work of wisdom.

The conduct free from miserliness is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes generosity a source of conceit. The conduct free from corrupted moral discipline is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes ethical conduct a source of conceit. The conduct free from ill-will is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the

conduct of one who makes patience a source of conceit. The conduct free from laziness is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes diligence a source of conceit. The conduct free from distraction is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes meditative concentration a source of conceit.

The conduct free from errant wisdom is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes wisdom a source of conceit. The conduct free from afflictions is the conduct of bodhisattvas — but it is not the conduct of one who makes freedom from afflictions a source of conceit. The conduct of relinquishing all inner and outer things without attachment is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of giving up sons, daughters, and wife without manifest delight is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of always dwelling in ill-will by condemning the qualities of desire is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of not looking to oneself through properly gathering roots of virtue is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of not looking to oneself, through not clinging to body and life, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct free from hesitation through relinquishing both the pleasant and the unpleasant is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct free from fear, through being undaunted by immeasurable cycles of existence in saṃsāra, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of bearing a great burden through relieving all sentient beings of their burden is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of irreversibility, through bringing to fruition whatever vows were previously made, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct free from remorse, through having no heaviness of mind, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of eminence, through surpassing all vehicles, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of vajra-like armor, through the indestructibility of one's samaya, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of definitively attending to one's own mind, through definitively attending to the minds of all sentient beings, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of non-waste, through the non-waste of whatever actions have been done, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct free from distinction, through an even mind toward all sentient beings, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of the courageous, through definitively vanquishing all enemies, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of the unmixed, through engaging in harmony with those of equal fortune, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of bringing joy, through bringing joy to all who are hostile and hateful, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of joy, delight, and supreme gladness, through

supreme love for beholding buddhas, hearing the Dharma, and attending upon teachers, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of adornment, through adorning buddha-fields with body, speech, and mind, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct that is not overwhelmed, through being an antidote to both the equal and the unequal, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct that is not base, through being praised by those who are wise and discerning, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct free from intoxication, through properly and thoroughly examining afflictions, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of a noble being, through fulfilling the burden one has taken up, is the conduct of bodhisattvas.

The conduct that advances without turning back, through steadfast diligence, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct in accordance with the Dharma, through perfectly gathering the qualities that are aids to awakening, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of knowing what has been done and preserving what has been done, through not cutting the lineage of the buddhas, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of the Three Jewels, through not diminishing the Three Jewels, is the conduct of bodhisattvas. The conduct of wisdom and skillful means, through gathering and thoroughly discerning, is the conduct of bodhisattvas.

When this teaching on the conduct of bodhisattvas was set forth, five hundred bodhisattvas who had entered into conduct attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).

Then the divine son, the caravan leader, spoke thus to Mañjuśrī, the youthful one: "Mañjuśrī, you have spoken well of the conduct of bodhisattvas. Those bodhisattvas who are inseparable from that conduct have themselves been prophesied."

The Blessed One declared: "Divine son, it is so. It is exactly as has been said. Divine son, at the time when I became inseparable from that conduct, the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara prophesied me to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, and at that time I attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena. Divine son, moreover, one who discerns those qualities whose defining characteristic is pure conduct, who distinguishes the conduct of bodhisattvas as it truly is — this too is the great miraculous display of the Tathāgata."

Then the divine son, the caravan leader, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is this that is called non-arising? By what

entry does a bodhisattva attain the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena?"

The Blessed One declared: "Divine son, the expression 'non-arising' is a word of praise (literally, an elusive term) carrying the defining mark of primordial unorigination. It is not that something formerly arose and afterward ceased to arise — it is that it was primordially unoriginated from the very beginning. It is not that something formerly existed and afterward became impossible — it is that it was primordially impossible from the very beginning. It is not that something formerly came to birth and afterward remained unborn — it is that it was primordially unborn from the very beginning. It is not that something was formerly compounded and afterward became uncompounded — it is that it was primordially uncompounded from the very beginning. It is not that something formerly existed and afterward ceased to exist — it is that it was primordially without change from the very beginning. It is not that something was formerly counted as a person and afterward ceased to be counted as a person — it is that it was primordially emptiness from the very beginning. It is not that something was formerly reckoned as a sign and afterward ceased to be reckoned as a sign — it is that it was primordially signless from the very beginning.

Whoever thus realizes this, and, through the mind, understands birth and destruction without clinging to them — that is what is called non-arising.

And what is the acceptance with respect to this? Acceptance of all sentient beings, just as they are, as non-arisen — that is called acceptance. Acceptance of all buddha-fields, just as they are, as non-arisen — that is called acceptance. Acceptance of all those in training, those beyond training, and all pratyekabuddhas, just as they are, as non-arisen — that is called acceptance. Acceptance of all buddha qualities, all the conduct of bodhisattvas, and"

acceptance of all buddhas, just as they are, as non-arisen — that is called acceptance. Just as those are non-arisen, so too acceptance of all phenomena, just as they are, as non-arisen — that is called acceptance.

This acceptance, furthermore, is momentary. Why is it momentary? It is momentary by virtue of its own momentariness. Emptiness is momentary by virtue of emptiness. Signlessness is momentary by virtue of signlessness. Just as emptiness and signlessness are momentary by virtue of emptiness and signlessness, so too form is momentary by virtue of the defining characteristic of form. Just as emptiness and signlessness are momentary by virtue of

emptiness and signlessness, so too feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are momentary — consciousness being momentary by virtue of the defining characteristic of consciousness. Just as emptiness and signlessness are momentary by virtue of emptiness and signlessness, so too the element of all phenomena is momentary by virtue of the defining characteristic of the dharma-element. Just as emptiness and signlessness are momentary by virtue of emptiness and signlessness, so too all sense bases are momentary by virtue of the defining characteristic of the sense bases.

Whatever is momentary is hollow. Whatever is hollow is empty. Whatever is empty is a mere husk. Whatever is a mere husk is without attachment. Whatever is without attachment is free from attachment. Whatever is free from attachment is without essential nature. Whatever is without essential nature is without any thing whatsoever. This is what is meant when all phenomena are spoken of as empty, momentary, hollow, solitary, and void. Acceptance of all phenomena in just this way — that is called acceptance.

This acceptance, too, is momentary by virtue of acceptance itself. A bodhisattva who has thus attained to equanimity is one who has received a prophecy and has attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena. Yet even that acceptance is not divided by reference to an object. What, then, is reference to an object? Whenever one takes both a self and acceptance as referents, that is called reference to an object. Whenever one takes both a sentient being, a life-force, a vital essence, a person, and acceptance as referents, that is called reference to an object.

And what is non-reference to an object? Whenever one takes neither a self nor acceptance as referents, that is called non-reference to an object. Whenever one takes neither a sentient being, a life-force, a vital essence, a person, nor acceptance as referents, that is called non-reference to an object. The same reasoning applies throughout. The essential nature of all phenomena — the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases — is an essential nature that has no fixed ground. Whatever has no fixed essential nature is unconditioned. Not conceiving dualistically of that essential nature and that acceptance — that is called non-reference to an object.

O son of the gods, a bodhisattva endowed with such acceptance who acts in this way for innumerable eons — that itself is a display of the great miraculous power of the Tathāgata.

When this teaching on acceptance was proclaimed, this great trichiliocosm trembled in six ways. This world was pervaded by a great radiance. A hundred thousand musical instruments sounded without being played. Showers of flowers rained down. Forty-two thousand living beings gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Ninety-six thousand bodhisattvas attained conformative acceptance with respect to phenomena.

In this world-system called Endurance, there likewise appeared everywhere a vision of the Tathāgata Dīpakaśrī, the King of Light, entering the palace of lotus flowers.

Then at that moment the Blessed One smiled. Whenever the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, smile, it is in the very nature of reality that many hundreds of thousands of rays of light in manifold colors and various hues issue from the mouth of the Blessed One — blue and yellow and red and white and crimson and crystal and silver — and these, having pervaded with their radiance world-systems without limit or bound, rise up even to the Brahmā worlds, eclipsing the light of sun and moon alike, and then return and absorb into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, knelt on his right knee, and with palms pressed together in reverence directed toward the Blessed One, offered at that very moment these verses befitting the occasion:

For what reason, O Sage, have you smiled?

You who possess unequaled majesty, I ask of you.

You who have spread forth a brilliant display of light, I ask of you.

You who dispel the afflictions of dimness and obscuration, I ask of you.

O Sugata, for what reason have you shown a smile?

You who subdue the armies of the other side, I ask of you.

You who have utterly vanquished the forces of Māra, I ask of you.

You who possess the ten powers, I ask of you.

O Victor, for what reason have you shown a smile?

You adorned with the marks, possessing the thirty-two qualities.

O Sugata, maker of supreme joy and bliss.

You who possess a sublime form, I ask of you.

O Blessed One, for what reason have you shown a smile?

You who reveal qualities of boundless knowledge.

You who, as the wellspring of gnosis, know all beings.

O tree of gnosis, pinnacle of wisdom, I ask of you.

Your fame is proclaimed through all three worlds without bound.

You have brought to an end the three knowledges and the three impurities.

You have passed to the end of the three knowledges and three liberations known through the three worlds.

For what reason, tell us, have you shown a smile?

O supreme physician who has brought birth and old age to an end,

O Blessed One, at whose feet are the excellent wheel-marks.

Son of Nirgrantha, firm as a vajra —

O Sage, please declare the cause of your smile.

Whose conduct has been perfectly purified?

Whose acceptance in this teaching has been completely fulfilled?

Whose mind is certain to attain the qualities of a buddha?

For what reason, O great Sage, have you smiled?

O peerless Sugata, you do not smile without a reason.

O Blessed One, O Guide, you do not show a smile without cause.

Hearing the reason, sentient beings will be gladdened in their hearts.

With the voice of Brahmā, please speak and proclaim it well.

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, while this teaching of the Dharma was being proclaimed, forty-two thousand living beings gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Ninety-six thousand bodhisattvas attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena.

"And furthermore, Ānanda, do you see that divine youth, the caravan leader? The Blessed One replied: 'Yes, Blessed One, I see him.' The Blessed One said: 'Ānanda, this divine youth, the caravan leader, attended, venerated, honored, made offerings to, thoroughly requested, and thoroughly questioned Tathāgatas beyond counting — indeed beyond accurate reckoning — and also caused immeasurable sentient beings to truly take hold of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.'"

"Ānanda, after three hundred immeasurable eons have passed, this divine youth, the caravan leader, will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening in a world-realm called 'Totally Pure' during an

age called 'Stainless.' He will appear in the world as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans — a buddha, a Blessed One, named Yontan Gyalpo Ö, King of Qualities, Light.

"Ānanda, that world-realm called 'Totally Pure' will be composed of these seven precious substances: gold, silver, lapis lazuli, crystal, ruby, emerald, and red pearl; it will be level as the palm of one's hand, and covered all over in a pattern of nets of many precious jewels. In that world-realm, even the names of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas will not arise. Likewise, the names of tīrthika wanderers (non-Buddhist ascetics), vagrant mendicants, māras, and sentient beings who reject the true Dharma will not exist and will not arise there. In that buddha-field there will be none of the eight states of non-leisure, and food and drink will come into being by the mere wish of the mind. In that buddha-field, transgressions, the faults of error, and even the sound of suffering will not arise. The enjoyments and pleasures of those sentient beings will be just like the enjoyments and pleasures of the gods who master others' emanations. All those sentient beings will have a golden complexion and will be adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being, and the great majority will arise having entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — and it is for this reason that world-realm is called 'Totally Pure.'

"The lifespan of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Yontan Gyalpo Ö, will be forty intermediate eons. The bodhisattvas there will not die prematurely in the interval, by the power of their aspirational prayers. The bodhisattva Saṅgha of that Tathāgata will number sixty million hundred thousand and twenty million. Ānanda, those bodhisattvas who have aroused the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and those who have attained the acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena — all of these will be reborn in that Totally Pure world-realm. And every one of them will receive, in that buddha-field, a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening from the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha Yontan Gyalpo Ö.

"Then, in that very assembly, there was present a divine youth named Avalokiteśvara. He scattered divine Mandārava flowers before the Blessed One and spoke these words:"

"Blessed One, I too, at the time when the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Yontan Gyalpo Ö, attains unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, shall be reborn

in that Totally Pure world-realm and shall become a wheel-turning king. In that role I will pay homage and render service to that Tathāgata together with his Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, and after that Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa, I too shall attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening in that same world-realm."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, this divine youth Avalokiteśvara — at the time when the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Yontan Gyalpo Ö, attains unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, he will be born there as a wheel-turning king named Sudarśana. He will make immeasurable offerings to that Blessed One and will bring the qualities conducive to awakening to their full completion. Then, after that Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa, he will attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and will arise in the world as the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha — endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans — the Buddha, the Blessed One, whose name shall be Universally Luminous.

"Ānanda, that same King Sudarśana, at another time, will entrust the kingdom to his eldest son, and with faith in the teaching of that Blessed One, will go forth from home into homelessness. And when the time comes for that Tathāgata to pass fully into nirvāṇa, he will give that bodhisattva a prophecy, saying: 'This bodhisattva Sudarśana will attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening after I have passed into nirvāṇa.' Having given that prophecy, he will pass fully into nirvāṇa."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to the divine youth who was the caravan leader: "Divine youth, have you received a prophecy from the Tathāgata?" He replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I have been prophesied just as the Tathāgata's emanation was prophesied. For suchness as it is at present, so too is suchness in the future — suchness neither increases nor diminishes."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up this enumeration of the Dharma, hold it, master it, recite it, teach it fully — and proclaim it extensively and correctly to others as well, for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, and for the benefit and the complete embrace of happiness by the bodhisattvas of the present and the future."

Ānanda asked: "Blessed One, I shall take it up. But what is the name of this enumeration of the Dharma, and how should I hold it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, hold this enumeration of the Dharma by the name 'The Revelation of the Great Miracle.' Also hold it by the names 'Revealed by Mañjuśrī in His Youthful Form' and 'The Chapter of All Precious Things.'

"Ānanda, whatever sons or daughters of good family take up this enumeration of the Dharma, have faith in it, and out of that faith commit it to writing, read it, recite it aloud,

and extensively and correctly teach it to others — those persons will be thoroughly encompassed by all merit.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda, the divine youth Merchant-Captain, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, the entire assembly gathered there, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This completes the twenty-second chapter, entitled "The Revelation of the Great Miracle, Requested by the Divine Youth Merchant-Captain," from the hundred-thousand-chapter enumeration of the Dharma of the noble Great Heap of Precious Things (Skt. Mahāratnakūṭa).

Translated, revised, and definitively edited by the Indian masters Jinamitra, Surendrabodhi, and Prajñāvarman, together with the great-translation monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage, concluding with an incomplete enumeration beginning "whether wholesome, or non-wholesome, inferior, or —" (dge ba'am, mi dge ba'am, dman pa'am). This is a natural mid-text break at the end of the supplied Tibetan; the translation faithfully renders it as it stands.

The title Ārya-mahā-pratihārya-nirdeśa corresponds to "The Noble Demonstration of the Great Miracle," where pratihārya (miracle or wonder-working) is the Sanskrit used. The Tibetan འཕྱུག་པའི་ཕུ་དཔོན་ renders this throughout.

The divine youth named འཕྱུག་པའི་ཕུ་དཔོན་ (lha'i bu ded dpon) literally means "divine youth, caravan leader." This appears to be a proper name or epithet; "Caravan Leader" is retained as a descriptive rendering rather than as a Sanskrit reconstruction, since no Sanskrit original is supplied in the passage.

- The phrase rendered "worlds of Yama, the Lord of Death" translates a term for the preta

realm presided over by Yama; in some enumerations this corresponds to the hungry-ghost realm, but the Tibetan here uses the Yama-world formulation, which I have rendered literally rather than substituting "hungry ghosts," since the text's own taxonomy may differ slightly from the standard five or six.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, mirroring the Tibetan source, which appears to be incomplete at this point. The continuation presumably repeats and concludes the same series of negations before completing Mañjuśrī's speech.

The "son of the gods, the caravan leader" is a compound epithet in Tibetan rendering a single figure — likely a deity named Sārthavāha or similar — who was introduced earlier in the text and addressed the Blessed One.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end ("possessed of a body, or of mind —"), which reflects the continuity structure of the original; the text continues in the next passage.

The series "born of seed" and "offspring of seed" renders संनिवृत्त and जन्तु respectively. These are two of the classical pseudo-entities (often rendered from Sanskrit as jantu and jīva-type terms) that Buddhist texts list when enumerating the various designations people use for the supposed self; they refer to beings conceived as arising from semen or vital essence. The rendering is deliberately literal to preserve the rhetorical force of the list.

- The passage presents a rhetorically symmetrical series of paradoxes: each ultimate reality (emptiness, the signless, nirvāṇa, etc.) is by nature beyond speech, yet the Tathāgata's act of speaking it is itself the miracle. This is a standard Mahāyāna soteriological point about the Buddha's teaching activity as transcendent performance rather than mere description.

The term rendered "non-construction" translates a phrase meaning "non-fabrication" or "non-compounding" (relating to saṃskāra in the sense of volitional constructions); "non-occurrence" is the arising-forth or manifestation of conditioned phenomena being absent. These are left as natural English equivalents rather than technical Sanskrit reconstructions because no single Sanskrit correlate is certain from context alone.

- The phrase "divine son, the merchant's leader" renders *lha'i bu ded dpon*, where *ded dpon* is a caravan leader or merchant chief — a figure who has appeared earlier in the text. The form of address places him as a divine being (*lha'i bu*, "son of the gods") who is simultaneously identified by this epithet. This is consistent throughout.

The "three spheres utterly purified" (khor gsum yongs su dag pa) refers to the standard Mahāyāna analysis of any virtuous act as ideally free from reification of agent, object, and action — here applied sequentially to each of the six perfections.

- The Blessed One's quotation of four inconceivable domains closely parallels a well-known passage found in Pāli and Sanskrit sources, where the four "unthinkables" include the domain of karma, the domain of the meditative absorptions, the domain of nāgas or the world, and the domain of a buddha. The rendering here follows the Tibetan closely.

The world system named here in Tibetan as "Bde ba" rendered "Sukhāvātī" deserves a note: this may or may not be identical with the well-known pure land of Amitābha; the name is the same but the context places it in an unspecified remote past, and it is likely a separate occurrence of the name rather than a reference to Amitābha's realm.

- The epithet "Like Mount Meru" renders the buddha-name Merukalpa or similar; the Tibetan gives ri rab Ita bu, "resembling Mount Meru / like Sumeru," used as a proper epithet throughout this passage.

The term *kāṣīlindi* (Tibetan *ka tsa lin di*) refers to a particularly fine silk fabric, likely from *Kāṣī* (Varanasi); the exact Sanskrit form is uncertain but the referent is a luxury textile renowned for its softness.

- The phrase rendered "gathering and freedom from distraction" for समाधिराज्यविमोक्ष could alternatively be read as "collectedness and freedom from distraction," referring to the quality of concentrated stillness; the rendering chosen preserves both senses. The four recollections listed here correspond to the classical set of the four recollections of the Three Jewels plus ethical discipline, with the addition specifying that the ethical discipline here is characterized by generosity and non-forgetfulness of bodhicitta, which is a distinctive Mahāyāna elaboration worth noting.
- The phrase rendered "the feet of miraculous power" translates the idiomatic term for the four bases or legs of miraculous power (*ṛddhipāda*), here expressed in singular form; this is a standard Abhidharma category.

- The phrase rendered "in an instant" for མཚན་མོན་པོ་ལྔ་ཡི་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟོག་པར་ is an interpretation of an idiom meaning something like "at a stroke" or "in a single moment," used here to indicate the immeasurability of the merit of bodhicitta extended as wide as space. The exact syntactic scope of the line is slightly compressed in the Tibetan.

- The phrase rendered "fully differentiated" translates "rab tu phye ba," which in this apophatic context carries the sense of awakening being distinctly set apart by virtue of its non-arising; the meaning is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and the rendering is a considered approximation. The tripartite formula "free from the three defining characteristics" most likely refers to the Yogācāra three natures — the imputed, the dependent, and the thoroughly established — though in this Madhyamaka-inflected context it may simply mean the three characteristics of conditioned existence (arising, abiding, ceasing); neither reading can be ruled out with certainty from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase "following the Dharma without need of a teacher's guiding example" renders *chos la slob dpon gyi dpe mkhyud med pa*. This is a somewhat condensed formulation; the sense is that the bodhisattva, through teaching the Dharma without personal gain, attains or embodies a state where no external teacher's prompting is required — the Dharma guides from within. This reading is contextually supported but the precise nuance is worth noting.

In the verse "those young sons" (bu stong pa), the term stong pa can mean "empty" or "young/unmarried." In context it almost certainly refers to the king's young, unmarried sons rather than to some abstract quality. This reading is followed in the translation.

- The prince's name, Mahākaruṇāmatī, rendered in the Tibetan as "Greatly Minded with Compassion," is here kept in Sanskrit on its first full appearance and glossed in the rendering so listeners follow both the epithet and the name together.

The passage on the eight-limbed precepts refers to the eight-branch precepts of the poṣadha (restoration) observance — a lay vow traditionally maintained for one day and night at a time. The prince's vow to uphold these for as long as he lives is doctrinally notable and is consistent with the sūtra's theme of householder bodhisattvas achieving equivalence with monastics through compassionate motivation and ethical rigor.

- The phrase rendered "caravan leader, son of a god" reflects the Tibetan "lha'i bu ded dpon," where "lha'i bu" is a divine epithet meaning "son of a god" and "ded dpon" is the caravan leader figure identified earlier in the narrative. The identification of this figure has been maintained consistent with the preceding passage.

The Tibetan "ngo mtshar" type enumeration for beings — "dung phyur phrag dgu dang bye ba phrag gnyis" — is rendered as "nine hundred and seventy thousand and two hundred million." This large-number enumeration follows standard classical Tibetan usage where "dung phyur" equals one hundred thousand and "bye ba phrag" equals ten million; the translation reflects the straightforward arithmetic reading.

- The passage "the holy life is the totality of spiritual friends" renders a phrase that functions elliptically: the holy life, taken in its fullness, encompasses or just is the entirety of good spiritual friendship. The following contrast — that Mañjuśrī does not commit himself definitively to virtue or non-virtue — reflects a Mahāyāna non-dual standpoint beyond the ordinary framework of spiritual friendship, not an endorsement of non-virtue.
- The phrase rendered "the ultimate limit of reality" translates yang dag pa'i mtha', literally "the true limit" or "the real limit," a standard Mahāyāna term for ultimate reality or the absolute limit, sometimes rendered "the limit of the real" or "the absolute extreme." The rendering chosen fits the context and the running series.

The "seven stations of consciousness" refers to the classical Abhidharma enumeration of the seven viññānaṭṭhiti, the bases or stations in which consciousness takes pleasure and establishes itself; this is a standard doctrinal list and is rendered accordingly.

The "nine objects of vexation" renders kun nas mnar sems kyi dngos po dgu, the nine bases of hostility or resentment, a standard Abhidharma list.

- The phrase rendered "rooted in equanimity yet also not equanimity" presents a slight tension in the Tibetan, which lists wisdom and equanimity together in what appears to be a compound suggesting that the bodhisattva's wisdom is not reducible to mere equanimity — meaning wisdom is cultivated but not collapsed into a passive indifference. The rendering "rooted in wisdom yet also rooted in equanimity" follows the most natural syntactic reading; the deeper nuance is that these are held together in dynamic tension rather than as contradictory qualities.

The nine successive meditative absorptions refer to the standard set of nine attainments culminating in the cessation of perception and feeling.

- The term rendered "the three definitive teachings on the basis of meaning" translates the Tibetan phrase for what appears to be a structured threefold doctrinal exposition that Mañjuśrī has just completed; the precise referent depends on the larger sūtra context and is noted here for scholarly attention.

The progression from "no full grasping" through "no wavering," "no agitation," and so forth is a deliberate chain-style argument modeled loosely on the style of dependent origination

exposition; each link has been rendered as literally as readable English allows.

- The chain of negations in the opening passage is a continuation of the apophatic sequence from the preceding section; "the very interval leading to right meditative absorption" renders Tibetan that literally means "the span or interval up to right meditative absorption," indicating that right view is the entire stretch of the path culminating in right samādhi. The phrase "no cognitive awareness" renders a term for discernment or recognition that is distinct from the word for consciousness used earlier; both are aspects of knowing but the distinction reflects a nuance in the original. The final sentence of the passage is deliberately left open with a dash, as the Tibetan ends mid-construction and flows into the next passage.
- The phrase rendered "the cognition that knows abiding in what has no abiding-place" translates a paradoxical formulation pointing to the bodhisattva's non-abiding nirvāṇa, where one dwells in neither saṃsāra nor a quiescent nirvāṇa — a key Mahāyāna doctrinal point.

The "close placements of mindfulness," "thorough relinquishments," "bases of miraculous power," and "branches of awakening" are standard sets from the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening (bodhipākṣika dharmas), rendered here in their traditional enumeration.

- The phrase rendered "sentient beings who are by their very nature completely beyond sorrow" reflects the Tibetan rang bzhin gyis yongs su mya ngan las 'das pa'i sems can — beings who are naturally or intrinsically parinirvāṇa-ed. This is a technically significant Mahāyāna doctrinal point: the bodhisattva, understanding the ultimate purity and naturally nirvāṇic nature of all beings, is not alarmed by this insight but rather wears it as armor. The passage marks the beginning of a new fascicle (third and final section), indicated in the Tibetan by the colophon phrase.
- The phrase rendered "take rebirth in existence" translates "srid pa len par byed pa," literally "taking on existence," meaning they willingly accept continued rebirth in saṃsāra rather than passing into nirvāṇa, in order to serve beings. The context makes the sense clear without interrupting the narration.

The phrase "yon ssum tshogs pa" rendered as "excellent foundation" carries the sense of being a perfectly complete basis or treasury of benefit — a standard epithet in this catechetical genre.

- The phrase rendered "do not make wisdom into an object of activity" translates the idea that wisdom, in its ultimate mode, does not objectify itself or become a reified project — a standard Madhyamaka and Prajñāpāramitā nuance meaning that one does not grasp at wisdom as something to be produced or possessed.

The phrase "the full extent of the past limit" renders a technical expression for the beginningless beginning of saṃsāra; "the true limit" refers to the ultimate limit, that is, reality or the dharmadhātu, from which the bodhisattva does not deviate even while recollecting past lives.

The line on miracles, "they can display all māras," means the bodhisattva can manifest or portray māra-like appearances as a skillful means without themselves being defiled — a reading supported by the parallel structure of the surrounding passages.

- The phrase rendered as "patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena" corresponds to the standard Mahāyāna term anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the insight-patience that phenomena do not truly arise, attained on the higher bodhisattva grounds. The Tibetan here reads mi skye ba'i chos la bzod pa, which is the standard Tibetan equivalent.

The dialogue in this passage employs a consistent dialectical pattern in which Mañjuśrī accepts apparently negative characterizations of himself and then redefines each term at a subtler,

more expansive level. This is a recognized literary and doctrinal device in Mahāyāna sūtra literature, showing that conventional ethical categories are transcended by the bodhisattva's universal compassionate engagement.

- The exchange about liberation not becoming liberation again is a deliberately paradoxical statement playing on the unconditioned nature of liberation: true liberation has no further transformation, so "re-liberating" the liberated is meaningless. The Tibetan is terse here and the paradox is intentional.

The phrase rendered "the sound of another's voice" translates *pha rol gyi sgra nyan pa*, literally "listening to the sound of the other side." In this context it most likely means clinging to verbal or doctrinal formulations as such, playing on the idea that attachment to the literal sounds of teaching is itself an obstacle to liberation. This reading is contextually and doctrinally supported.

- The repeated dialectical formula — "the domain of X is a buddha's domain, yet the buddha's domain is not the domain of X" — is a deliberate paradox central to the text's Madhyamaka orientation: the buddha's awareness encompasses all phenomena without being constituted or limited by any of them. No single English rendering fully dissolves this tension, and that is intentional.

The phrase rendered "all-pervasive fluctuation" for *kun tu g.yo ba* in the context of perception (*saṃjñā*) is somewhat unusual; the Tibetan literally means "totally stirring or moving," suggesting the restless, differentiating activity of perception. The rendering reflects this functional sense.

"The three defining marks" of the conditioned element refers to the classical Abhidharma triad of arising, abiding, and ceasing — the three characteristics of all conditioned phenomena (*saṃskṛta*).

- The three qualities of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness correspond to the three gateways to liberation (*vimokṣamukha*) standard in Abhidharma and *Prajñāpāramitā* literature. Their appearance here alongside seven further modes of equanimity (non-arising through *nirvāṇa*) follows a common sūtra enumeration. The term rendered "volitional construction" for *abhisamkāra* refers specifically to deliberate mental fabrication or striving, distinct from the aggregate of formations (*saṃskāra*); the absence of such striving is a mark of genuine meditative insight. The passage on "conceit" arising from the perfections is a notable doctrinal point: a bodhisattva practices the six perfections but does not reify or take pride in them, lest the practice itself become an obstacle.

- The phrase rendered as "the conduct of always dwelling in ill-will by condemning the qualities of desire" is syntactically unusual and may represent a compressed or elliptical statement. Contextually, within this series of paradoxical formulations, the probable intended meaning is that the bodhisattva's conduct includes maintaining a perpetual disposition of aversion directed specifically toward the allurements of desire, which is itself a form of renunciation, not ordinary ill-will toward persons. The tension in the phrasing appears intentional.

The term rendered as "samaya" in the phrase "vajra-like armor" refers to the tantric vow or pledge. The Tibetan *dam tshig* (*yi dam* in the text) carries this technical sense of a sacred commitment whose indestructibility is compared to a vajra.

- The phrase rendered "a word of praise carrying the defining mark of primordial unorigination" translates the somewhat difficult Tibetan *mtsig bla dgas yin te* (here *anupādalakṣaṇapada*). The compound is an encomium or honorific epithet-phrase; the rendering captures its function as a term of commendation pointing to the ultimate characteristic of non-arising. The Sanskrit underlying this is likely an expression such as *anupādalakṣaṇapada* used in praise. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the

supplied Tibetan, and the translation follows the text exactly to that point.

- The terms rendered "hollow," "empty," "husk," and "void" translate four Tibetan words used as near-synonyms in a chain of equivalences: ya ma bra (hollow/empty like a split bamboo internode), gsog (empty inside, like a hollow reed or vessel), gsob (husk or shell, the outer casing of something empty within), and dben pa (solitary, isolated, vacant). These are technical quasi-synonyms elaborating the single concept of being devoid of any substantial core, deployed here in a rhetorical cascade. The rendering attempts to preserve their graduated, reinforcing character rather than collapsing them into one word. The chain ends in "without any thing whatsoever," rendering dngos po med pa, the absence of any real entity.
- The verse epithet rendered "Son of Nirgrantha" translates the Tibetan "Sred med sras po" — literally "son of Nirgrantha" or "son of the one without craving," a recognized epithet of the Buddha in certain contexts, occasionally understood as a patronymic. The intended meaning is that the Buddha, as heir to the teaching of liberation, is himself beyond craving. This is a conventional Indic epithet and has been rendered literally.

The verse line about "three knowledges, three impurities, three liberations" reflects a dense condensed list of classical Buddhist categories; the translation follows the Tibetan closely, though the precise enumeration may be drawn from a specific commentarial tradition not identified here.

- The buddha-name rendered here as "Yontan Gyalpo Ö" (ཡོན་ཏན་རྒྱལ་པོ་ཨོ) means literally "Light, King of Qualities." It is left in Tibetan transliteration as a proper name since no standard Sanskrit equivalent is established in the context of this text; a listener may understand it by the literal gloss given in the epithet "King of Qualities, Light."

The "eight states of non-leisure" refers to the eight unfavorable rebirths (the eight akṣaṇas) in which one lacks the opportunity to practice the Dharma — a standard doctrinal category that the general listener will recognize from the phrase's context even without elaboration.

- The epithet rendered "Universally Luminous" translates Kun tu Öd, a buddha-name formed on the same pattern as Yontan Gyalpo Ö; both names are kept in a hybrid Tibetan-Sanskrit form in the original, and the translation renders them by their literal meaning as is standard for such buddha-names in this text.

The phrase rendered "complete embrace of happiness" represents yongs su gzung ba, literally "complete taking hold of," applied to happiness — a slightly technical locution meaning something like "fully securing" or "thoroughly maintaining" wellbeing; the rendering chosen preserves both readability and the sense of encompassing or safeguarding.

The divine youth addressed by Śāradvatīputra is identified in context as Avalokiteśvara, who earlier in the sūtra was introduced in the role of a caravan leader (ded dpon); the two references are consistent.

- The name "Merchant-Captain" renders the Tibetan honorific title for a caravan or sea-merchant leader (devaputra); the Sanskrit equivalent would be śreṣṭhin or sārthavāha. The colophon names three Indian paṇḍitas and the Tibetan lo tsā ba Yeshé Dé, a standard ninth-century translation team working under royal patronage — no uncertainty here, only contextual clarification for listeners unfamiliar with the Tibetan canonical colophon conventions.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.